

PENTHOUSE

Shooting Script & Scene Breakdown — bilingual (English / తెలుగు)

A feature-length two-hander · single continuous film · 32 scenes · approx. 4 hr 33 min

Draft dated 6 October 2026

How to read each scene	Every scene opens with a header block (scene number, INT/EXT, location, story day/date and time, actors with costume number, approximate screen duration, props and furniture). The grid below runs beat by beat: action with its camera angle and lens on the left, dialogue in English with the Telugu line beneath it on the right. A shoot-instructions box closes each scene.
Cast on screen	Only RANI (35) and VIKRAM (25) appear on screen. Every other person is a voice on a phone (Ammamma, Vikram’s mother, Sravya, Kiran) or an off-screen presence. Crowds in Scene 1 stay out of focus.
Intimacy	All intimate moments are implied and cut away on a look, a light switch, a door or a match-cut. An intimacy coordinator is required on every bedroom scene; closed set, modesty garments throughout, no nudity. Customers are never seen.
Telugu address	Until Scene 25 Rani and Vikram use the respectful మోదరు; after the reveal they drop to నువ్వోమ.
Camera package (assumed)	Single camera, full-frame cinema body; prime set 24 / 35 / 50 / 85 mm and 100 mm macro; Steadicam and slider days as noted; drone for Scene 1 only. Lens and angle notes are a starting brief for the DOP.
Story calendar	Day 1 = Monday 9 June (arrival). The film ends at dawn on Day 119, Sunday 5 October. Dates are for continuity only and never appear on screen.

Costume plot

RANI

No.	Costume	Scenes
R1	Turmeric-yellow cotton saree, plain blouse, glass bangles, rubber chappals, cloth shoulder bag (arrival; returns for the final scene)	1, 2, 31, 32
R2	Faded green cotton saree, pallu tucked at waist for housework	6, 9, 12, 18
R3	Fresh sky-blue cotton saree, hair wet and loosely knotted	4, 5
R4	Maroon cotton saree, evening wear at home	7, 8, 10, 15, 20
R5	Soft grey cotton saree worn for sleep	3, 11, 14, 21
R6	Blue jeans (shop tag on, then removed) and sleeveless red top, barefoot, hair loose	12, 13
R7	Vikram's grey hoodie over a cotton nightie	16, 24
R8	Her best silk saree, peacock blue with zari border	18, 19
R9	Spa uniform: lilac tunic and trousers, name badge (drying on rail as set dressing)	21
R10	Montage wardrobe set: cotton kurti with jeans; floral knee-length dress; cotton shorts and T-shirt (bedroom only); rain-soaked chiffon saree; red nail polish	16
R11	Mustard cotton saree, hair braided by Vikram (lopsided)	16, 17
R12	Vikram's oversized black T-shirt and cotton pyjamas	22, 27
R13	Plum cotton saree, worn for the evening Leela call-in	23
R14	Faded orange cotton saree; after Scene 26 a grey towel wrap (modest	25, 26

	framing)	
R15	Black sheer georgette saree bought by Vikram, gold-tone necklace, heels, small evening purse	26
R16	Montage wardrobe set (dark phase): shawl over printed nightie; muted synthetic sarees; same black saree in variation	28
R17	Her late mother's red silk saree, jasmine garland, turmeric-yellow thread	29
R18	Printed chiffon saree with dupatta over her head, soaked through (wet doubles needed)	30

VIKRAM

No.	Costume	Scenes
V1	Black crew T-shirt, blue jeans, leather wrist band, sunglasses in hair, white sneakers	1, 2
V2	Grey vest and black track pants (night at home)	3, 8, 30
V3	White T-shirt, grey shorts, barefoot (mornings)	4, 5, 11, 14
V4	Printed casual shirt and chinos (evenings / event days)	6, 9, 10, 12, 13, 18
V5	Black hoodie and joggers	7, 15
V6	Montage wardrobe set: T-shirts, rain-soaked linen shirt, kurta for birthday night	16, 17
V7	White linen shirt sleeves rolled, dark jeans (celebration dinner)	19
V8	Bare back with towel draped over it, track pants (massage practice; modest framing)	20
V9	Navy T-shirt and track pants	21, 22, 23, 24, 28

V10	Towel at waist after shower, hair wet; later navy T-shirt	25
V11	Dark bomber jacket over black shirt, car keys (booking nights)	26, 27, 28
V12	Plain white cotton kurta and pyjama	29
V13	Same grey vest and track pants as V2, crumpled from a night on the floor	31, 32

Scene index

Sc.	Slug line	INT/EXT	Story day & time	Duration
1	EXT. MGBS BUS STATION / CITY ROADS — EARLY MORNING	EXT	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 05:45–06:30 (first light)	~5 min
2	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — MORNING	INT / EXT	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 06:45–07:30	~8 min
3	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — NIGHT	INT	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 23:30	~10 min
4	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NEXT MORNING	INT	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 08:00	~8 min
5	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE MORNING	EXT	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 11:00	~5 min
6	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — EVENING	INT	Day 4 · Thu 12 June · 18:30	~10 min
7	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT	INT	Day 5 · Fri 13 June · 21:00	~5 min
8	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — NIGHT, RAIN	INT	Day 7 · Sun 15 June · 22:30	~12 min
9	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — DAY	INT	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 14:00	~8 min
10	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT	EXT	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 21:00–23:30	~12 min
11	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NEXT MORNING	INT	Day 11 · Thu 19 June · 09:30	~4 min
12	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — AFTERNOON	INT	Day 13 · Sat 21 June · 15:00	~8 min
13	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 15 · Mon 23 June · 23:45 to dawn	~12 min
14	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — MORNING	INT	Day 16 · Tue 24 June · 07:30	~10 min
15	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE AFTERNOON	EXT	Day 17 · Wed 25 June · 17:00 to sunset	~6 min
16	MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — DAYS AND NIGHTS	INT / EXT	Days 18–26 · 26 June – 4 July · various; birthday night Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 22:00	~10 min
17	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 23:30	~5 min
18	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — DAY / EVENING	INT / EXT	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 09:00 (morning) and 18:30	~8 min

			(evening)	
19	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT	EXT	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 21:00	~6 min
20	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 33 · Fri 11 July · 22:00	~10 min
21	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT	INT	Day 52 · Wed 30 July · 23:00 (time-cut runs to Day 59)	~12 min
22	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — SUNDAY, RAIN ALL DAY	INT	Day 56 · Sun 3 August · 11:00–16:00 (rain all day)	~5 min
23	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 63 · Sun 10 August · 23:30	~12 min
24	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN	EXT / INT	Day 64 · Mon 11 August · 05:45	~6 min
25	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT	INT	Day 67 · Thu 14 August · 23:20–23:50	~15 min
26	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / BATHROOM / HALL — SATURDAY NIGHT	INT / EXT	Day 69 · Sat 16 August · 19:30 → 02:50 → dawn 05:50	~12 min
27	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — LATE MORNING	INT	Day 70 · Sun 17 August · 10:30	~5 min
28	MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — WEEKS	INT / EXT	Days 71–110 · 18 August – 26 September · various nights and afternoons	~10 min
29	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT	EXT	Day 112 · Sun 28 September · 21:30	~7 min
30	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT, RAIN	INT	Day 118 · Sat 4 October · 23:50 → 03:00 (storm, power cut)	~15 min
31	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — BEFORE DAWN	INT	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 04:30	~6 min
32	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN	EXT	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 06:00 (sunrise)	~6 min

= new romance scene added in this draft.

SCENE 1 EXT. MGBS BUS STATION / CITY ROADS — EARLY MORNING

Scene No.	1	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	MGBS Bus Station, Platform 14; bike ride via Tank Bund to Gachibowli	Story day, date & time	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 05:45–06:30 (first light)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree, plain blouse, glass bangles, rubber chappals, cloth shoulder bag VIKRAM — Costume V1: black crew T-shirt, blue jeans, leather wrist band, sunglasses pushed into hair, sneakers		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Steel trunk (dented, village paint), cloth bag, Rani's basic keypad phone, Vikram's smartphone, Royal Enfield (black), bungee cord, helmet (Vikram only). Background: luggage and bus silhouettes kept soft-focus		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
1.1 Black screen. The hiss of an overnight bus braking. Then a phone ringing. CAMERA Black frame; sound design only. Phone ring pans L→R.	VIKRAM'S MOTHER (<i>V.O., on phone</i>) Vikram, are you awake? Rani's bus reached. Platform 14. Don't keep her standing there like a parcel. And listen — she's a decent woman. Treat her like family. వోక్రమ్, లేచావా? రాణి బస్సు వచ్చిందో. ప్లాట్ఫాం 14. ఫ్యామిలీగా చూడు. ఆమె మంచి మనిషి. మన ఇంటి మనిషిలా చూసుకో. VIKRAM (<i>O.S., sleepy</i>) Amma, I'm already on the bike. Bye. అమ్మా, ఆల్ రెడీ బైక్ మీదే ఉన్నా. బై.

1.2 FADE IN on a crowded platform, shot so that no other face is ever sharp: soft shapes, a blur of luggage. In the middle, in sharp focus, RANI (35) in a cotton saree the colour of turmeric, one steel trunk, one cloth bag. She grips the bag handle like it is the only thing she owns. She is not frightened. She is alert, the way people are when they have been hit before. CAMERA WIDE to MS, eye level, 85mm at T1.8 so the crowd melts. Slow 4-second push-in to her grip on the bag handle (insert, 100mm macro).	—
1.3 Her phone buzzes. Unknown number. She hesitates, then answers. CAMERA Insert on keypad phone screen (100mm). Back to MCU Rani, 85mm, slight low angle.	RANI Hello? హలో? VIKRAM (V.O.) Rani garu? Vikram. Look left. The black bike. The idiot waving. రాణీ గారూ? వీక్రమ్ నీ. ఎడమ వైపు చూడండి. నల్ల బైక్. చేతులూపుతున్న ఆ పోస్ట్మన్.
1.4 She turns. VIKRAM (25), sunglasses pushed up into his hair, black T-shirt, a leather band on his wrist, leaning on a Royal Enfield, waving with both arms like he is guiding a plane. She almost smiles, then stops herself. CAMERA Whip-pan with her look to LONG SHOT Vikram on the bike, 50mm. Return to CU Rani for the almost-smile, 85mm.	—
1.5 He jogs up and takes the trunk before she can protest. CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm handheld, eye level, following his jog into frame.	VIKRAM You brought the whole house? ఇల్లు మొత్తం తీసుకువస్తారా? RANI Only what was mine. నాదీ అనదీ మొత్తం.
1.6 He looks at her for a second longer than he means to. Then he laughs it off. CAMERA OTS from behind Rani onto Vikram, 85mm; hold the extra second before he laughs.	VIKRAM Then it's light. Come. అయితే బరువేం లేదు. రండి.

1.7 ON THE BIKE. The trunk is tied behind with a bungee cord. Rani sits sideways, saree pallu tucked tight, one hand on the grab rail, refusing to touch him. Hyderabad wakes around them: flyovers, the lake at Tank Bund, the glass towers of Gachibowli catching the first sun. Her eyes are wide. CAMERA Tracking vehicle: frontal two-shot, 35mm, low angle; profile tracking 50mm along Tank Bund; POV plates of the city, 24mm. CU Rani's eyes, 85mm, for wonder.	VIKRAM <i>(shouting over the wind)</i> First time in Hyderabad? హైదరాబాద్ ఇదే మొదటిసారి? RANI First time anywhere. ఎక్కడోక్కడా ఇదే మొదటిసారి.
1.8 A speed breaker. The bike jolts. Her hand flies off the rail and lands on his shoulder. She takes it back immediately, as if burned. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hand landing on his shoulder and lifting off. Cut to MCU Vikram reacting in the mirror, 50mm.	VIKRAM You can hold on. I don't bite. పట్టుకోవచ్చు. నోనోం కరవను.
1.9 She does not hold on. But she does not let go of the rail either. Title card over the city: PENTHOUSE. CAMERA Drone: high wide following the bike across the flyover into the sunrise, 24mm equivalent. Title card over the plate.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot platform at blue hour; extras only as out-of-focus shapes (no faces sharp, no dialogue). Bike ride on tracking vehicle with Rani side-saddle; stunt-safe speed under 20 km/h, closed road permissions for Tank Bund. Title card PENTHOUSE is a post graphic over the Gachibowli skyline plate. Phone V.O. recorded clean in studio.

SCENE 2 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — MORNING

Scene No.	2	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — hall cum kitchen and terrace door	Story day, date & time	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 06:45–07:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V1: black T-shirt, jeans		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Messy dressing: pizza boxes, ashtray on floor, clothes over couch, beer cans in cooler box, sink full of mugs, event lanyards on nail, rolled banner "NEON NIGHTS — SATURDAY", garbage bags. Furniture: 3-seater couch, small dining counter with 2 stools, two-burner stove, fridge, balcony door. Terrace: plastic chair, 6 dead potted plants, water tank. Vikram's second phone (older model)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
2.1 The door opens on chaos. Pizza boxes. An ashtray on the floor. Three days of clothes over the couch. A cooler box of beer cans by the fridge. The sink a museum of mugs. Event-company lanyards hang from a nail. A large rolled banner says "NEON NIGHTS — SATURDAY". CAMERA POV from doorway, 24mm, eye level; slow pan across the mess. Inserts on ashtray, sink, banner (50mm).	—
2.2 Vikram drops her trunk and kicks a shoe under the couch, too late. CAMERA WIDE master, 24mm from front door; both in frame.	VIKRAM It's — normally it's cleaner. అదీ — మామూలుగా ఇంకా నీట్ గా ఉంటుంది. RANI (<i>taking it in</i>) Normally. మామూలుగా. VIKRAM Okay, it's never cleaner. Event week. I sleep four hours. సరే, ఎవ్వుడూ ఇలాగే ఉంటుంది. ఈవంట్ వీక్. నాలుగు గంటల నీడ్ర్.

2.3 He opens the balcony door. Light pours in, and the view opens out across the city: a terrace bigger than the flat itself, a plastic chair, dead plants in pots.

CAMERA Reverse from terrace looking in as door opens, 35mm; light flare entering. Cut to wide of terrace, 24mm.

2.4 Rani steps onto the terrace slowly. Wind lifts the end of her pallu. For the first time we see her face fully relax. She closes her eyes.

CAMERA Slow dolly behind her stepping out, 35mm; cut to CU face, 85mm, slight low angle against open sky. Insert: pallu lifting in wind (100mm, 48fps).

VIKRAM

The real house is outside. The flat is just where I keep my mess.

అసలు ఇల్లు బయట ఉందో. లోపల ఉన్నదో నా చౌత త దాచుకున్నో చోటు మౌత రమో.

RANI

So much sky.

ఎంత ఆకాశమో.

VIKRAM

You like it?

నచ్చుందో?

RANI

In my in-laws' house there was one window. It faced a wall.

మా అత్త-త-రంటలో ఒక్క కటే కటికీ ఉండేదో. అదో కూడా గోడ వైపే.

2.5 She says it lightly. He hears it heavily. He leans in the doorway.

CAMERA MCU Vikram in the doorway frame, 50mm, eye level; door frame as a frame-within-frame.

VIKRAM

Listen. Amma told me everything — I mean, not everything. That you need a job. That you need a place. Here, this place — feel like it's your own home. Okay? Not guest. Home.

వసించండి. అమ్మమ్మ అంతా చూపిస్తోంది — అంటే, అంతా కాదు. మనకు ఉద్యోగం కావాలని. ఉండటానికి చోటు కావాలని. ఈ ఇల్లు — మన సొంత ఇల్లు అనుకోండి. సరేనా? గౌరవ్ కాదు. ఇల్లు.

RANI

People say that.

అందరూ అలాగే అంటారు.

VIKRAM

I'm not people. I'm the neighbour's son who stole mangoes from your Ammamma's tree. She chased me with a broom.

నేను అందరిలాంటివాడిని కాదు. మనీ అమ్మమ్మమ్మ చూట్టు మామడికాయలు దొంగిలించిన పక్కంటి పిల్లవాడిని. చీమరు పట్టుకుని తరిమింది నన్ను.

2.6 Rani laughs — a real, surprised laugh — and covers her mouth with her hand, as if laughing is something she must apologise for.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; hold through the laugh and the hand to her mouth.

VIKRAM

See? Home.

చూశారా? ఇల్లంటే.

2.7 She turns back to the flat, looks at the mess, and quietly begins tying her pallu at her waist.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: hands tucking pallu at waist. MS two-shot as he protests.

VIKRAM

No, no, no — you just came. Rest.

వద్దు వద్దు వద్దు — ఇప్పుడే వచ్చారు. కాస్తేమ రిస్ట్ తీసుకోండి.

RANI

I rest better in a clean room.

శుభ్రంగా ఉన్న గదిలోనే నాకు రిస్ట్ బాగుంటుంది.

2.8 She picks up the first pizza box. He watches, embarrassed, then grabs a garbage bag and starts helping. They work in silence. When their hands reach for the same mug, they both let go and it nearly falls. He catches it. CAMERA WIDE master, 24mm, for the silent cleaning (can run as a short time-lapse). Insert, 100mm: two hands on one mug; slow-motion catch at 60fps.	VIKRAM Reflexes. Event manager. రఫ్లెక్స్ అవ్వాలి. ఈవెంట్ మేనేజర్ కదా. RANI What does an event manager do? ఈవెంట్ మేనేజర్ అంటే ఏం చేస్తారు?
2.9 The smallest pause. CAMERA Tight CU Vikram, 85mm; hold one beat.	VIKRAM Makes sure people get what they paid for. జనం దేన్నోకొ డబ్బు కట్టారో, అదో వాళ్ళ లకో అందేలా చూస్తాడు.
2.10 His phone — a second phone, older, in his back pocket — vibrates. He glances at it, silences it, puts it face down on the fridge. Rani does not notice. The camera does. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: phone vibrating in back pocket; rack focus to Rani in background unaware. Final insert: phone face down on fridge top.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Establish the flat's geography here for the whole film: one master wide from the front door covering couch, counter, stove and terrace door. Mess must be photographed for continuity (it returns in Scene 28). The second phone is a planted clue: one clean insert, never emphasised by music.

SCENE 3 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — NIGHT

Scene No.	3	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom doorway, bed	Story day, date & time	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R5 : soft grey cotton saree worn for sleep VIKRAM — Costume V2 : grey vest, black track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Double bed with white sheet, 3 pillows (the "China border"), extra pillow in Vikram's hand, split AC unit (practical with hum), window with city view, bedsheet folded on couch, clean mugs in a row on counter		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
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3.1 The flat is transformed: floors mopped, a bedsheet on the couch, the mugs in rows. Vikram stands in the bedroom doorway holding a pillow.

CAMERA WIDE from bedroom looking out to hall, 24mm; reveal the cleaned flat. MS Vikram in doorway, 50mm.

VIKRAM

Bed's yours. I'm on the couch.

బెడ్ మీదే. నేను సోఫాలలో పడుకుంటా.

RANI

No. Your house, your bed. I'll sleep on the couch.

వదల్దు. మీ ఇల్లు, మీ బెడ్. నేనే సోఫాలలో పడుకుంటా.

VIKRAM

There's no AC in the hall. It's thirty-four degrees at midnight. You'll melt.

హాలలో ఏసీ లేదు. అర్ధరాత్రి కూడా ముప్పై నాలుగు డిగ్రీలు. కరిగిపోతారు.

RANI

I've slept on floors in May with no fan. Thirty-four is nothing.

మే నెలలో ఫ్యాన్ కూడా లేకుండా నేల మీద పడుకున్నా. ముప్పై నాలుగు ఏం లాక్క.

VIKRAM

That's exactly why you're not sleeping on the couch.

సరిగ్గా అందుకే మీరు సోఫాలలో పడుకోవడానికి వీలై లేదు.

3.2 She stops. He did not mean it as a punch, but it lands. She looks down.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eyes dropping. Reverse CU Vikram realising, 85mm.

VIKRAM *(softer)*

Sorry. I mean — you've done enough of that. Take the bed.

సారీ. అంటే — అలాంటివి ఇవ్వటానికి చాలా చేశారు. బెడ్ తీసుకోండి.

RANI

And you will sweat on a couch for two weeks because of me? I'll feel guilty every night. Guilt is hotter than May.

నా వల్ల మీరు రెండు వారాలు సోఫాలలో చముటలు కక్కుతారా? రోజూ రాత్రి నాకు గొల్లటేగా ఉంటుంది. ఆ గొల్లటే మే ఎండ కంటే వేడే.

3.3 They stand at an impasse. He tries a different route. CAMERA Symmetrical two-shot, 35mm, eye level; bed between them in frame.	VIKRAM Fine. Couch for you. Then I'll also sleep in the hall, on the floor, out of protest. Both of us will melt. The AC will cool an empty room. Very sensible. సరే. సోఫా మీకే. అయితే నేను కూడా సరిసనగా హాలలోనే నేల మీద పడుకుంటా. ఇదోదరం కరగోపదాం. ఏసీ ఖాళీ గదిలో చల్లబరుస్తోందో. చాలా తలీవైన పని.
3.4 She almost laughs again. She looks at the bed. It is large. She looks at him. CAMERA Her POV: the bed, 35mm. Back to MCU Rani, 50mm.	RANI It's a big bed. బెడ్ పాదదదే. VIKRAM It's a very big bed. చాలా పాదద బెడ్.
3.5 A long beat. CAMERA Hold the two-shot; no cut.	RANI One side each. Pillows in the middle. ఒక్కొక్కరికీ ఒక వైపు. మధ్యలో దొండలు. VIKRAM A wall. Like the China border. ఒక గోడ. చైనా బార్డర్ లాగా. RANI Like the China border. చైనా బార్డర్ లాగా.
3.6 LATER. Lights off. The AC hums. A blue strip of city light falls across the bed. Between them, a wall of three pillows. Both lie on their backs, eyes open, staring at the ceiling. CAMERA Top shot (overhead), 24mm, rigged on a ceiling mount: two bodies, three pillows between. Lock off.	—

3.7 Her hand is folded over her mangalsutra-less neck — a habit she has not broken. He notices it in the half light.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hand at her bare neck. Side profile two-shot at mattress level, 50mm.

VIKRAM (*whispering*)

Are you sleeping?

నీదోరపోయారా?

RANI

No.

లేదు.

VIKRAM

Me neither.

నేనూ లేదు.

RANI

I haven't slept in a room with AC before.

ఏసీ గదిలో ఇంతకు ముందోపొడు పడుకోలేదు.

VIKRAM

How is it?

ఎలా ఉందో?

RANI

Too quiet. In the village there are dogs, buffaloes, Ammamma snoring. Here I can hear my own heart.

మరీ సైలెంట్ బద్దంగా ఉందో. ఊర్లో కుక్కలు, గోదాలు, అమ్మమ్మ గుర్రక. ఇక్కడ నా గుండె చప్పుడే నాకు వినోపిస్తోందో.

VIKRAM

What's it saying?

అదో ఏమంటోందో?

3.8 She takes a long time to answer.

CAMERA CU Rani on pillow, 85mm, lit only by the blue strip.

RANI

That I left my children in a village and came to a stranger's house in a city I don't know.

పోల్ లలోనో ఊర్ లోనో వదిలేసి, తాలూకాలోనో ఊర్ లోనో, పరాయి మనషి ఇంటికి వచ్చాననో.

VIKRAM

I'm not a stranger. Mango thief. Remember?

నేను పరాయివాడినో కాదు. మామడికాయల దొంగనో. గుర్తుందా?

RANI

Mango thief.

మామడికాయల దొంగ.

3.9 She turns on her side, away from him. He turns on his side, away from her. Two backs, one pillow wall. Hold the shot long enough to become uncomfortable. Slow fade.

CAMERA Return to overhead, 24mm; hold 15 seconds; slow fade to black.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Night interior: motivated blue city-light strip through the window (LED tube outside with diffusion), AC practical on for sound. Record room tone with AC on. Pillow-wall count must be tracked across scenes: 3 here, 2 after Scene 8, 1 by Scene 13, gone after.

SCENE 4 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NEXT MORNING

Scene No.	4	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — hall cum kitchen	Story day, date & time	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 08:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R3: fresh sky-blue cotton saree, hair wet and loose-knotted VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts, barefoot		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Kadai with tadka (mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic — real cooking), steel plate of upma, steel tumbler and dabara of filter coffee, spoon, washed curtains drying on terrace rail, couch cover turned to clean side, dead plants lined in a row on terrace, Vikram's main phone on bed (referenced), counter stool		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
4.1 Vikram wakes alone in the bed. He hears a sizzle. He smells something he has not smelled in this flat in two years: tadka. Mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic. CAMERA MCU Vikram waking, 50mm, high angle. Insert, 100mm: mustard seeds popping in the kadai (high frame rate).	—
4.2 He walks out barefoot, hair wild. The hall is unrecognisable. Curtains washed and drying on the terrace rail. The couch cover turned inside out to its clean side. A steel plate of upma on the counter, a tumbler of filter coffee beside it. The dead plants on the terrace have been lined up in a row, untouched. CAMERA Steadicam following Vikram from bedroom into hall, 24mm; reveal the transformed space in one move.	—

4.3 Rani is at the stove in a fresh cotton saree, hair still wet, a single strand stuck to her neck. She hums an old Telugu film song, very softly, and stops the moment she sees him.

CAMERA MS Rani at stove in profile, 50mm, backlit by the window. Insert, 100mm: wet strand of hair on her neck.

VIKRAM

You're humming.

మీరు పాట హామి చీస్ తున్నారా.

RANI

I wasn't.

లేదు.

VIKRAM

You were. Ghantasala.

చీస్ తున్నారా. ఘంటసాల.

RANI

My father's songs. Eat before it gets cold.

మా నాన్నగారి పాటలు. చల్లగా తినండి.

4.4 He sits on the counter stool and eats. Closes his eyes on the first mouthful.

CAMERA CU Vikram eating, 85mm; hold the eyes closing (callback shot for Scene 31).

VIKRAM

Where did you even get rava? I don't own rava.

అసలు రవ్వు ఎక్కడోంది? నా ఇంట్లో రవ్వు లేదు.

RANI

You own a grocery app. I found it on your phone.

మీ దగ్గర గ్రోసరీ యాప్ ఉంది. మీ ఫోన్ లో చూశా.

4.5 He freezes for half a second.

CAMERA Push-in on Vikram, 85mm, 1-second creep.

VIKRAM

Which phone?

ఏ ఫోన్ లో?

RANI

The one on the bed. Why, you have two?

బెడ్ మీద ఉన్నదాంట్లో. ఏం, రెండు ఉన్నాయా?

VIKRAM *(easy smile)*

One for clients, one for Amma. Amma calls too much.

ఒకటి క్లయింట్స్ కి, ఒకటి అమ్మకి. అమ్మ మరీ ఎక్కువ ఫోన్ చేస్తోంది.

RANI

She worries. Mothers worry.

కంగారు పడుతోంది. అమ్మలంతా.

4.6 She turns back to the stove. He eats watching her back. Something in his face softens and calculates at the same time.

CAMERA OTS from behind Vikram onto Rani's back at the stove, 50mm; then CU Vikram, 85mm, for the double read.

VIKRAM

What do you want to do? For work.

మీరేం చేయాలనుకుంటున్నారా? ఉద్యోగంగా.

RANI

Anything that pays. I can cook. I can clean. I studied till ninth class. I can sew blouses. I can do accounts in my head faster than your calculator.

డబ్బులొచ్చే ఏ పనినా. వంట చేయగలను. ఇల్లు శుభ్రం

చేయగలను. తామ్రమీదో తరగతి వరకు చదివా. జాకెట్లు

కుట్టగలను. మీ కాలిక్యులేటర్ కంటే వేగంగా మనసులోనే

లెక్కలు వేయగలను.

VIKRAM

Ninth class?

తామ్రమీదో తరగతేనా?

RANI

Then I got married.

తర్వాత పెళ్ళి అయిపోయింది.

4.7 She says it to the frying pan. He puts the spoon down. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: spoon set down on the steel plate. MCU Rani facing the stove, 85mm.	VIKRAM At what age? ఎన్ నేళ్ళ లకి? RANI Coffee is getting cold. కాఫీ చల్లారా పోతోందో.
4.8 He takes the hint. Drinks the coffee. She does not turn around. CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, from the terrace door: her back, him drinking. Hold.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Real tadka on set for sizzle and steam; food stylist on standby, keep 3 identical plates of upma for takes. Morning daylight through terrace door (HMI outside, 5600K). Rani's humming must be an original or cleared tune; the same tune recurs in Scenes 15 and 31.

SCENE 5

EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE MORNING

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	5 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — dead-plant corner by the water tank	Story day, date & time	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 11:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R3: sky-blue cotton saree, pallu tucked at waist VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	6 terracotta pots with dry soil, jasmine root and tulasi root (greens dept: live cutting with visible pale-green root), plastic bucket filled with water, steel mug, small trowel (unused — he digs with hands), plastic chair, Vikram's phone		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
5.1 The Terrace Garden. Rani kneels among the dead pots, sifting dry soil through her fingers. Vikram ends a call on the terrace and watches her. CAMERA WIDE from the water tank, 35mm, Vikram foreground soft ending his call, Rani sharp among the pots. Insert, 100mm: soil running through her fingers.	VIKRAM Those are dead. I killed them in March. అవి చచ్చిపోయాయి. మార్చి చిల్లో నేనే చంపేశా. RANI Nothing is dead if the root is alive. Look. వేరు బతికుంటే ఏదీ చచ్చిపోనట్టే. చూడండి.

5.2 She holds up a thin, pale-green root.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: root against the sky, shallow focus. Then MCU Rani, 50mm, low angle.

RANI

This is jasmine. And this one, tulasi. You had a tulasi and you let it die? Amamma would beat you with the same broom.

ఇదో మల్లాలా. ఇదో తులసీ. ఇంట్లో తులసీ పాటోటుకునో
ఎండోపొనో చ్చోచారా? అమ్మమ్మ అదే చీమరుతో కూడుతుందో
మమ్మమ్మనో.

VIKRAM

What do I do?

నోనోం చోయాలి?

RANI

Bring water. Not too much. Plants are like people. Too much love also drowns them.

నీళ్లు తీసుకురండి. మరో ఎక్కువ కాదు. మౌక్ కల్లా
మనుషులలాంటివే. పోరేమ ఎక్కువైనా మునోగోపోతాయి.

5.3 He brings a full bucket and pours far too much. Mud splashes up across his mouth and chin. She bursts out laughing.

CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm, eye level from pot height. Splash at 60fps for a gentle slow-motion beat.

RANI

Mango thief. Exactly the same face.

మామిడికాయల దొంగ. అచ్చం అదే ముహం.

5.4 She wipes his cheek with the end of her pallu, then realises how close she is. She stops. He does not move.

CAMERA Tight two-shot in profile, 85mm; the gap between faces centred. Hold.

VIKRAM

You didn't finish.

ఇంకా పూర్ తోగా తుడవలేదు.

5.5 She hesitates, then wipes the rest, slowly. Their eyes meet and hold. She steps back and busies herself with the pot.

CAMERA Alternating CUs, 85mm, eye-line matched. Return to MS as she pulls away.

RANI

In fifteen days, this will flower.

పదహారు రోజుల్లో ఇది మూసేతుంది.

VIKRAM

You'll be here in fifteen days?

పదహారు రోజులకీ మీరు ఇక్కడనే ఉంటారా?

RANI

The plant will be here. That's enough.

మొక్క ఉంటుంది కదా. అదీ చాలు.

5.6 He kneels beside her and digs with his bare hands. They plant together in silence while the city hums below. Close on two pairs of muddy hands pressing soil around one root. This jasmine returns in Scene 29.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: two pairs of muddy hands round one root. Crane/jib up and back to a high wide of two figures and the skyline, 24mm.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot between 10:30 and 11:30 for hard top-light softened by a 12x12 silk. Mud splash is practical: prepare 3 clean T-shirts (V3 doubles) and face wipes. Plant the jasmine pot in a fixed, marked position — the same pot must show a bud in Scene 16 and full flowers in Scene 29.

SCENE 6 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — EVENING

Scene No.	6	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, on the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 4 · Thu 12 June · 18:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R2: faded green cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Vikram's laptop (job portal open, rejection emails — screen replacement or live graphics), Rani's one-page résumé on screen, 2 glass cups of chai, pillow wall (3 pillows, one slightly flattened), bedside table, Vikram's second phone (screen shows "L — Spa")		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
6.1 Rani sits cross-legged on the bed with Vikram's laptop, two-finger typing. A job portal is open. A dozen tabs. Three rejection emails. Vikram enters with two cups of chai. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: two fingers typing. OTS onto screen, 50mm. MS Vikram entering doorway with chai, 35mm.	VIKRAM How many? ఎవ్వా? RANI Twenty-two applications. Three replies. All said "graduate preferred". ఇరవై రౌండు అప్ లోకేషన్ లు. మూడు రిప్ లైలు. అనన్స్ "గ్రాడ్యుయేట్ ప్రిఫర్డ్" అనన్సయ్. VIKRAM Preferred isn't required. ప్రిఫర్డ్ అంటే తప్పవనినరొ కాదు. RANI In this city, preferred is required. ఈ ఊర్ లో ప్రిఫర్డ్ అంటేనే తప్పవనినరొ.

6.2 He sits beside her — on her side of the pillow wall, which is still there, slightly flattened. He scrolls her résumé. It is one page, plain, honest.

CAMERA Two-shot from foot of bed, 35mm; the pillow wall visible behind them. Insert of résumé on screen.

VIKRAM

Date of marriage you've written here. Why?

ఇక్కడ పాళ్ళలో తేదీ రాశారు. ఎందుకు?

RANI

The form asked for marital status. I didn't know what to write. Married, divorced — both are lies in a way.

ఫామిలీ మ్యారేజీలో సేట్ చేసుకోవడా అడగారు. ఏం రాయాలో తెలియలేదు. పాళ్ళలయిందో, వీడాకులయ్యాయో — ఒక రకంగా రౌండ్ అబడేదే.

VIKRAM

Divorced is not a lie.

వీడాకులు అబడేదే కాదు.

RANI

It is a court paper. The marriage was the lie.

అదో కోర్టు కాగితం. పాళ్ళలో అసలు అబడేదే.

6.3 He sets the laptop aside. Waits. She looks at the chai.

CAMERA Slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, across 40 seconds of the speech that follows.

RANI

I was thirteen and a half. He was twenty-six. My father had a heart attack and wanted to see me "settled" before he died. He died anyway. Three months after the wedding.

నాకు పదమూడున్నర. అతనికి ఇరవై ఆరు. నాన్నగారికి గుండెపోటు వచ్చిందో, పోయేలోపు నన్ను "సేట్ చేసుకో" చేయాలనుకున్నారు. అయినా పోయారు. పాళ్ళలయిన మూడు నెలలకే.

VIKRAM

Thirteen.

పదమూడు.

RANI

And a half. I was proud of the half. I thought it made me older.

అర కూడా. ఆ అర అంటే నాకు గర్వంగా ఉండేది. దానితో పాడేదానో నయ్యో అనుకున్నా.

6.4 She laughs. It comes out wrong. He does not laugh.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, unmoving.

RANI

Sravya was born when I was fifteen. Kiran when I was sixteen. Everyone at the hospital thought I was the elder sister. The nurse asked where the mother was.

నాకు పదిహేనేళ్ళే అప్పుడు శర్మాయ్ ముట్టేసింది.

పదిహేనేళ్ళే అప్పుడు కిరణ్. ఆస్పత్రులో అందరూ నన్ను అక్క అనుకున్నారు. నర్స్ "అమ్మ ఎక్కడ?" అని అడిగింది.

VIKRAM

And now they're in college.

ఇప్పుడు వాళ్ళు కాలేజీలో ఉన్నారు.

RANI (*lighting up*)

Sravya is in final year B.Com. Kiran in second year engineering. Both first class. Both.

శర్మాయ్ బీకామ్ ఫైనల్ ఇయర్. కిరణ్ ఇంజనీరింగ్ సెకండ్ ఇయర్. ఇద్దరూ ఫస్ట్ క్లాస్. ఇద్దరూ.

VIKRAM

You did that.

అదీ మీరు చేసింది.

RANI

Ammamma did that. I only — survived.

అదీ అమ్మమ్మ చేసింది. నేను కేవలం — బతికాను.

VIKRAM

That's not only.

అదీ "కేవలం" కాదు.

6.5 She looks at him. He holds the look. She breaks it first and picks up the laptop.

CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm; she breaks eye-line first.

RANI

Help me write "preferred" things.

"ప్రీఫర్డ్ థింగ్స్" వ్రాయండి రాయడానికి సాయం చేయండి.

VIKRAM

We'll write true things. Twenty years managing a household of eight people. Accounts. Cooking. Child education. That's management. You're more qualified than half my clients.

నాజమైనవో రూద్దాం. ఎనిమిదో మందో ఉన్న ఇంటిని ఇరవై ఏళ్లు నడిపారు. లాక్ కలు. వంట. పోల్ లల చదువు. అదే మేనేజ్ మెంట్. నా క్లయింట్స్ లో సగం మందో కంటే మేకే ఎక్కువ అర్హత ఉందో.

RANI

What clients?

ఏ క్లయింట్స్?

VIKRAM

Rich people who need someone to arrange their happiness.

తమ సంతోషానికే వేరవరలో ఏర్పాటు చేయాలనుకునే డబ్బున్నోళ్లు.

6.6 She smiles at the phrase. On the bedside table, his second phone lights up silently. A name on the screen: "L — Spa". He turns it over.

CAMERA Rack focus from Rani's smile (foreground) to the glowing phone on the bedside table (background), 85mm. His hand enters and flips it.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Laptop screens: prepare live graphics of a job portal, three rejections reading "graduate preferred", and the résumé page; avoid real company names. Golden-hour practicals: bedside lamp on plus warm window bounce. The "L — Spa" caller ID is a planted clue: a single insert only.

SCENE 7 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT **NEW · ROMANCE**

Scene No.	7 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — stove, couch	Story day, date & time	Day 5 · Fri 13 June · 21:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V5: black hoodie, joggers		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Steel milk vessel, tea strainer, ladle, tea powder packet (delivery packaging), sugar jar, 2 steel tumblers / glass cups, kitchen sink, couch. Burn-safe milk boil-over rig (pre-boiled milk, low flame)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
7.1 The First Tea. Rani heads for the stove. Vikram steps into her path. CAMERA MS two-shot, 35mm, from the couch looking toward the kitchen.	VIKRAM Sit. Tonight I make tea. కూర్చోండో. ఈ రోజు టీ నేను చేస్తా. RANI You? You don't own tea powder. మీరూ? మీ ఇంటలో టీ పొడో లేదు. VIKRAM I own a grocery app. నా దగ్గర గ్రోసరీ యాప్ ఉందో కదా.
7.2 She laughs and sits on the couch, but keeps half-rising, unable to sit while someone else works. Each time, he points the ladle at her and she sits back down. The milk boils over. He burns a finger and swears under his breath. He adds sugar three times. He brings two cups: the tea pale, overboiled, far too sweet. CAMERA Comic master from the couch, 24mm, both in frame for the half-rising gag. Inserts, 100mm: milk boiling over; three spoons of sugar. MS as he carries two cups.	—

7.3 Rani takes a sip. Her face does something complicated. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eye level.	VIKRAM Bad? బాలేదా? RANI Terrible. ఘోరంగా ఉంది.
7.4 She drinks it anyway, slowly, holding the cup in both hands. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: both hands round the cup. Slow push-in to MCU as she speaks, 85mm.	VIKRAM You don't have to finish it. మొత్తం తాగక్కర్లేదు. RANI In thirty-five years, nobody has made me tea. Not once. Not my husband, not his mother, not even when I had fever after Kiran. I made tea for everyone and drank what was left at the bottom of the vessel, cold. This is the first cup anyone made only for me. Even if it's terrible, I'll finish it. ముప్పై ఐదేళ్లలో ఎవరూ నాకు టీ చేసి ఇవ్వలేదు. ఒక్కసారూ కూడా. నా భర్త కూడు, అత్తగారు కూడు, కిరణ్ మట్టాక జీవరం వచ్చినప్పుడు కూడా. అందరికీ నేనే టీ చేశా, గిన్నా అడుగున మిగిలింది చల్లగా తాగా. నా ఒక్కదాని కోసం ఎవరూ చేసిన మొదటి కప్ ఇది. ఘోరంగా ఉన్నా మారితోగా తాగుతా.
7.5 He is quiet. He takes her empty cup to the sink. She stands to wash it; he gently presses her back down by the shoulder. CAMERA MS, 50mm; insert of his hand on her shoulder pressing her down.	VIKRAM From tomorrow, morning coffee is yours. Evening tea is mine. Deal? రేపటి నుంచి పొద్దున కాఫీ మీది. సాయంత్రం టీ నాది. డీల్? RANI Even if it's terrible? ఘోరంగా ఉన్నా? VIKRAM Especially if it's terrible. ఘోరంగా ఉంటేనే మరి.

7.6 She laughs, wiping her eye with the back of her wrist. He blows on his burnt finger. She takes his hand, inspects the small burn, and without thinking blows on it too, the way she would for her children. Both realise it at the same moment. She does not let go immediately. Hold. Then she does.

CAMERA Static two-shot, 85mm, framed on the joined hands and both faces. Hold the realisation; no cut until she lets go.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Warm tungsten practicals only (kitchen tube off, under-cabinet strip on) to keep it cosy. Milk boil-over: art department to rig a controlled overflow; protect the hob. The burnt finger is a mime — no heat contact. Her blowing on his finger is the scene's key image; hold it on a static 85mm.

SCENE 8 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — NIGHT, RAIN

Scene No.	8	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — couch, with rain on the terrace beyond the glass; bedroom at the end	Story day, date & time	Day 7 · Sun 15 June · 22:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V2: grey vest, black track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Phone torch (Vikram's phone), drawer of event leftovers, 2 gold scented vanilla candles, matchbox, couch, rain on terrace, pillow wall (3 pillows → she removes one, leaving 2)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
8.1 A thunderstorm. The power goes out with a pop. Total dark, then lightning lights up the room in white flashes. Rani is on the couch, knees pulled to her chest. Vikram comes out of the bedroom with his phone torch. CAMERA WIDE, 24mm, locked off; lightning strobes reveal Rani in flashes. Handheld MS following Vikram's torch beam, 35mm.	VIKRAM You okay? బాగానో ఉన్నారా? RANI Yes. Thunder. Only thunder. ఆ. ఉరుము. ఉరుము మాత్రమే.
8.2 She is shaking. He sets the phone torch upright on the table so it bounces off the ceiling. He lights two candles from a drawer of event leftovers. Gold, scented, absurd. Vanilla. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: match flaring, candle wick catching. MS two-shot on couch, 50mm, candlelight key.	VIKRAM Event stock. Very romantic. Sorry. ఈవౌంట్రీ సౌత్వూక్. మరీ రొమాంటిక్ గా ఉందో. సారీ.
8.3 He sits on the far end of the couch. The rain hammers the terrace. A long silence. CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, couch length between them; rain on the glass behind.	RANI He used to come home on nights like this. ఇలాంటి రాత్రుఫోలీ అతను ఇంటికి వచ్చేవాడు.

8.4 Vikram does not ask who.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; he looks at her, says nothing.

RANI

He worked in a liquor depot. When it rained, the trucks stopped, so he came home early. Drunk. Lightning — then him. Lightning — then him. My body still thinks they come together.

అతను లిక్వర్ డెపోట్లో పని చేసేవాడు. వర్షం పడితే లార్కీలు ఆగిపోయేవి, అందుకే త్వరగా ఇంటికొచ్చేవాడు. తాగి. మృత్యువు — తర్వాత అతను. మృత్యువు — తర్వాత అతను. ఆ రెండూ కలిసే వస్తాయని నా ఒంటికి ఇప్పటికీ అనిపిస్తుంది.

VIKRAM

You don't have to tell me.

నాకు చెప్పవలసిన అవసరం లేదు.

RANI

No one has ever asked to hear it. Ammamma knows. But she says "forget".

You cannot forget with the body.

ఇదీ వినాలని ఎవ్వరూ ఎప్పుడూ అడగలేదు. అమ్మమ్మకు తలుపు. కానీ "మర్చిపో" అంటుంది. ఒళ్లు మర్చిపోదు.

8.5 She pulls the pallu over her shoulder tighter.

CAMERA Single on Rani, 85mm, candlelit, slow push-in through the next three lines (one continuous take).

RANI

My father promised two lakhs and five tolas of gold. He died before he could pay half. So for twenty years I was the unpaid half. My mother-in-law said it every morning with the coffee: "Even your father didn't think you were worth paying for."

మా నాన్నగారు రెండు లక్షలు, ఐదు తులాల బంగారం ఇస్తానన్నారని. సగం కూడా ఇవ్వకముందే పోయారు. అందుకే ఇరవై ఏళ్లు నేను ఆ కట్టనీ సగాననీ. పర్వతీ హద్దున కాఫీతో పాటు అత్యంతగా అదే అనేది: "నీ కోసం డబ్బు కట్టలేంత వీలువ నీకుందని మనీ నాన్న కూడా అనుకోలేదు."

8.6 Thunder. She flinches. CAMERA Lightning flash on the same take; do not cut.	RANI When I was seven months with Kiran, they wanted me to ask Ammamma to sell her land for the balance. I refused. He kicked me. Here. కోరణ్ కడుపులో ఏడో నెలపడు, బాకీ కోసం అమ్మమ్మనో పొలం అమ్మమ్మనో అడగమన్నారని. నేను ఒప్పుకోలేదు. అతను తన్నాడు. ఇక్కడ.
8.7 She touches her lower back, near the hip. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: her hand touching her lower back (this exact spot returns in Scene 25).	RANI I held on to the kitchen door so I wouldn't fall on my stomach. All I thought was — don't fall forward. Don't fall forward. The baby. I fell backwards on purpose. I broke my wrist instead. కడుపు మీద పడకుండా వంటింటి తలుపు పట్టుకున్నా. ఒక్కటే అనుకున్నా — ముందుకు పడకూడదు. ముందుకు పడకూడదు. బిడ్డే. కూవాలనో వానక్కో పడ్డే. బదులుగా మణికట్టు పోగొందో.
8.8 Her voice is steady. Her face is wet. She does not seem to know she is crying. CAMERA ECU, 100mm: tear on her cheek catching candlelight; eyes steady.	RANI In the hospital they wrote "slipped in bathroom". I signed it. With the left hand, because the right was in plaster. My signature looked like a child's. I suppose it was. ఆస్పత్రిలో "బాత్ రూంలో జారిపడింది" అని రాశారు. నేను సంతకం చేశా. ఎడమ చేత్తో, ఎందుకంటే కుడి చేత్తో కట్టు ఉంది. నా సంతకం చిన్నపిల్లల సంతకంలా ఉంది. బహుశా నీజంగా అదే.
8.9 Vikram slides closer. Stops. Waits. She looks at him, then at the space between them, and nods once. He puts his arm around her shoulder. She stiffens — her whole body like a fist — then, with a sound that is half a breath and half a sob, she collapses into him and cries properly, the way she has not let herself cry in twenty years. Hard, ugly, loud, the rain covering it. CAMERA Two-shot, 50mm, eye level on the couch; hold the slide, the nod, the collapse in one take. Then a slow orbit (slider arc) around them, 35mm.	VIKRAM Cry. Nobody's listening. Only the rain. And it's on your side. ఏడవండో. ఎవరూ వినటలేదు. వర్షం మాత్రమే. అదో కూడా మోస్తోంది.

8.10 She cries harder. He rocks her slightly. The candle flames tremble. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: candle flames trembling. Back to tight two-shot, 85mm.	RANI (<i>muffled</i>) Why did I stay so long? అంత కాలం ఎందుకు ఉండోయాను? VIKRAM Because you were thirteen when you got there. You don't leave the only house you know at thirteen. You leave when the kids are safe. You left the day they were safe. That's not late. That's exactly on time. ఎందుకంటే అక్కడోకి వాళ్ళ లాటప్ పటోకి మీకు పదమూడేళ్ళు. పదమూడేళ్ళకి తాలొసిన ఒక్క ఇంటినీ ఎవరూ వదలరు. పోల్ లలు సేఫ్ అయ్యాయాకే వదులుతారు. వాళ్ళు సేఫ్ అయిన రోజు మీరు వదలిశారు. అదో ఆలస్యం కాదు. సరేగ్గా సమయానికి.
8.11 She pulls back. Looks at him like no one has ever said that to her. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; reverse CU Vikram, 85mm.	RANI Who taught you to talk like this? ఇలా మాటలాడటం మీకు ఎవరు నేర్పారు? VIKRAM My job. People tell me their problems at three a.m. నా ఉద్యోగం. తొలలవారుజాము మూడింటికి జనం వాళ్ళ ల బాధలనో నాకే చూపతారు.
8.12 The lights come back on with a hum. They both blink, suddenly exposed. Her face swollen. His T-shirt wet with her tears. She moves away, embarrassed, wiping her face with the pallu. CAMERA Hard light change on cue (practicals snap on); MS two-shot, 35mm. Insert of tear-wet patch on his vest.	RANI I made your shirt dirty. మీ షర్ట్ మురికి చేశా. VIKRAM It was dirty before. You just washed it. ముందో మురికిగా ఉందో. మీరు ఇప్పుడే ఉతికారు.
8.13 She laughs through the tears. He gets up, turns off the overhead light, leaves the candles burning. CAMERA Wide, 24mm: back to candlelight as he kills the overhead.	VIKRAM Come. Bed. The AC is on our side too. రండో. పడుకుందాం. ఏసీ కూడా మన వైపు.

8.14 She follows him. In the bedroom, she stops at the pillow wall. Looks at it. Takes one pillow out of the three and places it at the foot of the bed. Two left. A smaller border. CAMERA Steadicam behind her into the bedroom, 35mm. Insert, 50mm: one pillow placed at the foot of the bed.	—
8.15 He sees it. Says nothing. They lie down. This time, she faces his side of the bed. Her eyes close. His stay open, watching her, and we cannot read him. Fade out. CAMERA Overhead, 24mm (matching Scene 3): two pillows now. Then CU Vikram's open eyes, 85mm, neutral light. Fade.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Rain towers on the terrace outside the glass; lightning via programmed strobe units (Lightning Strikes or LED equivalent) cued to sound. Blackout: all practicals cut, torch-bounce plus candlelight only (shoot wide open, high ISO). This is the film's emotional anchor: allow long uninterrupted takes for Rani's monologue; minimal crew in the room. The pillow count leaves at 2.

SCENE 9 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — DAY

Scene No.	9	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, wardrobe corner behind the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 14:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R2: faded green cotton saree, pallu tucked at waist VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos, keys in hand		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Bed on castor sliders (to drag), loose plywood panel at wardrobe base, hidden shelf: 4 whisky bottles, 1 rum, 1 vodka with frosted label, 2 cigarette cartons, Zippo lighter, box of hotel cocktail stirrers, slim ledger book with rubber band, plastic pouch of SIM cards; cigarette packet (prop/herbal), wardrobe mirror, broom and duster		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
9.1 Vikram is out. Rani, alone, is deep-cleaning the bedroom with the energy of someone who has nowhere else to put her nerves. She drags the bed away from the wall. Behind it, a loose plywood panel at the base of the wardrobe. She pulls it. CAMERA WIDE, 24mm, high angle from the corner: energetic cleaning. MS as she strains to drag the bed, 35mm. Insert, 50mm: her fingers prying the panel.	—
9.2 Behind it: a hidden shelf. Four bottles of whisky, one rum, one vodka with a frosted label, two cartons of cigarettes, a Zippo lighter, a box of cocktail stirrers from some hotel event. And, pushed far back, a slim ledger book with a rubber band around it, and a plastic pouch of SIM cards. She does not touch the ledger. She picks up a cigarette packet and turns it over in her hands like an artefact from another planet. CAMERA Her POV into the shelf, 35mm, slow reveal. Rack focus: bottles front → ledger and SIM pouch at the back (clue). Insert, 100mm: cigarette packet turning in her hands.	—

9.3 She sniffs it. Smiles. Glances at the door. Puts one between her lips, unlit, and looks at herself in the wardrobe mirror. A woman in a cotton saree with a cigarette. She looks ridiculous. She looks thrilling. She takes it out fast when she hears a key in the door. CAMERA Mirror shot, 50mm: her reflection with the cigarette, camera on her shoulder line. Sound cue: key in the lock.	—
9.4 Vikram walks in, sees the bed moved, sees the open panel, sees her with the packet behind her back. His face goes very still for a moment — his eyes flick to the ledger, which is untouched — and then he grins. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; his eye-line flicks to the ledger (cut-in insert, 100mm, ledger untouched), back to him grinning.	VIKRAM You found my temple. నా గుడిసో కనోపాటోటేశారు. RANI I was cleaning. శుభ్రం చేసోతున్నా. VIKRAM Behind the wardrobe. బీరువా వానకాల? RANI Dust doesn't respect wardrobes. దుమ్రుకో బీరువా అంటే గౌరవం ఉండదు.
9.5 He sits on the bed, amused. She brings her hand out from behind her back. The cigarette packet. CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm, him seated, her standing — she is taller in the frame for once.	RANI I wasn't going to — నేనోం తాగొలనో కూదు — VIKRAM Have you ever? ఎప్పుడైనా టోరై చేశారా?

9.6 She shakes her head. Then, quietly:

CAMERA MCU Rani, 85mm, slight high angle; she sits on the floor by the open panel through the speech.

RANI

Can I tell you something you'll laugh at?

మీరు నవ్వవో ఒక వాషయం చెప్పనా?

VIKRAM

Definitely.

కచ్చితంగా నవ్వుతా.

RANI

Every evening for twenty years, he would sit on the veranda and smoke and drink, and I would bring him water and pickle and onions. And I used to stand in the kitchen and watch the smoke go up. And I thought — what does it feel like to sit down? Not the smoke. The sitting down. With something in your hand that is only for you.

ఇరవై ఏళ్లు పోతే సాయంత్రం అతను వరండాలో కూర్చుని సాగర్, మందు తాగేవాడు. నేను నీళ్లు, ఊరగాయ, ఉల్లిపాయలు తాచో పాటేదానో. వంటింటలో నీలబడి ఆహారం వైకి వాళ్లుంటే చూసేదానో. అనుకునేదానో — అదీ ఎలా ఉంటుందో? పొగ కాదు. కూర్చోవడం. చేతిలో నా ఒక్కదానోదే అయిన ఏదో ఒకటి పట్టుకుని కూర్చోవడం.

9.7 He doesn't laugh.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, still.

RANI

I used to sniff his glass when I washed it. Like a thief. In-laws said women who drink are — you know what they said.

అతని గ్లాసు కడుగుతున్నప్పుడు వాసన చూసేదానో. దొంగలా.

తాగే ఆడవాళ్లు — అత్త తారంటలో ఏమనేవారో మీకు తెలుసు.

VIKRAM

I know what they said.

ఏమనేవారో తెలుసు.

RANI

Ammamma would die.

అమ్మమ్మ చచ్చిపోతుంది.

VIKRAM

Ammamma drinks toddy on Sankranti. I've seen her.

సంక్రాంతికి అమ్మమ్మ కల్లు తాగుతుంది. నేను చూశా.

RANI (*shocked, delighted*)

Liar!

అబద్ధాలక్కోరు!

VIKRAM

Ask my mother.

మా అమ్మనో అడగండి.

9.8 She laughs so hard she sits down on the floor. He watches her laugh, and something in him decides.

CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, she on the floor laughing; push-in to CU Vikram, 85mm, as the decision forms.

VIKRAM

Tonight. Terrace. Class number one.

ఈ రాత్రి. టెర్రస్. మొదటి క్లాస్.

RANI

Class of what?

దేని క్లాస్?

VIKRAM

Sitting down.

కూర్చోవడం.

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

All liquor and cigarette brands to be fictional or de-branded labels. Ledger and SIM pouch are hero props for Scene 25 — lock their exact placement on the shelf and photograph. The unlit cigarette is a herbal prop. Statutory health warning cards to be added in post wherever smoking or drinking appears (CBFC requirement).

SCENE 10 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT

Scene No.	10	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — table set by the rail with the skyline behind	Story day, date & time	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 21:00–23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4 : maroon cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V4 : printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Warm-white fairy lights wound on the rail, 2 plastic chairs, folding table, tray: glasses (highball, rocks), steel bowl of ice, whisky bottle (de-branded; cold tea for liquid), soda bottles, limes, salt, jug of watermelon juice, mint leaves, cutting board and knife, black salt, rum and Coke (cola), vodka with orange juice, cigarettes (herbal) and Zippo, ashtray		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS

DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు

10.1 The terrace has become a stage. Fairy lights from his event stock wound around the rail. Two plastic chairs. A small folding table with a tray: glasses, ice in a steel bowl, a bottle of whisky, soda, lime, salt, a jug of watermelon juice, mint leaves, a cutting board.

CAMERA WIDE establishing, 24mm, from the terrace door: the set table, fairy lights, skyline. Detail inserts, 100mm, on the tray.

—

10.2 Rani steps out in her saree, uncertain. He pulls out her chair with exaggerated ceremony.

CAMERA MS, 35mm, from behind the table: she steps into frame; he bows.

VIKRAM

Madam, welcome to Club Penthouse. Membership: one.

మేడమ్, క్లబ్ హౌస్ పంట్ హౌస్ కి సవాగతం. మంబర్ షిప్: ఒకరు.

RANI

Two.

ఇద్దరు.

VIKRAM

Two.

ఇద్దరు.

10.3 LESSON ONE: THE CIGARETTE. He lights one, shows her how to hold it — between two fingers, not like a pencil. She holds it like a pencil. He corrects her fingers. Their hands touch. She inhales far too deep and coughs like a dying tractor. He thumps her back. She coughs and laughs, eyes streaming.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: fingers holding the cigarette like a pencil, his fingers correcting. Two-shot, 50mm, for the coughing gag.

RANI

This is what he liked? This is poison!

అతనికి నచ్చిందీ ఇదా? ఇదీ పోషం!

VIKRAM

Small puff. Hold it in your mouth only. Don't swallow the sky.

చిన్న దమ్ము. నోట్ లోన్ ఉంచండి. ఆకాశం మోత తం మింగేయకండి.

10.4 She tries again. Small puff. Lets it out slowly. Watches the smoke rise into the city light. Her face changes. Not pleasure in the cigarette. Pleasure in the watching.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, backlit so the smoke glows against the skyline; low angle.

RANI

I'm sitting down.

నేను కూర్చున్నా.

VIKRAM

You're sitting down.

మీరు కూర్చున్నారు.

10.5 LESSON TWO: THE PEG. He holds up a glass. CAMERA MCU Vikram, 50mm, holding the glass to the lights like a showman.	VIKRAM Small peg, thirty ml. Large, sixty. Patiala — that's for Punjabi weddings and broken hearts. Today we do small. స్కూల్ పాగ్, ముప్పై ఎంఎల్. లార్జ్, అరవై. పటియాలా — అదీ పంజాబీ పాళెలకొక్కో, వరంగోన గుండాలకొక్కో. ఈ రోజు స్కూల్ మాత్రమే.
10.6 He pours. Shows her: ice first, then whisky, then soda down the side of the glass so it doesn't kill the fizz. CAMERA Top-down insert, 100mm: ice, whisky, soda poured down the side.	VIKRAM Whisky with soda — gentleman's drink. Whisky with water — uncle's drink. Whisky with Thums Up — college drink. Never with Sprite. That's a crime. వస్కీ వత్ సోడా — జంటిల్ మన్ డ్రింక్. వస్కీ వత్ వాటర్ — అంకుల్ డ్రింక్. వస్కీ వత్ థమ్స్ అప్ — కాలేజీ డ్రింక్. స్ప్రైట్ మాత్రం ఎప్పుడూ వద్దు. అదీ నేరం. RANI Who made these rules? ఈ రూల్స్ ఎవరు పాటటారు? VIKRAM Bartenders at three a.m. తొలవారుజాము మూడంటి బారర్ టౌండర్లు.
10.7 He moves through it like a performance. Rum with Coke and a lime wedge squeezed and dropped in. Vodka with orange juice. Then the non-alcoholic: watermelon juice, crushed mint, lime, a pinch of black salt, soda on top. CAMERA Quick insert series, 100mm, cut to rhythm: lime squeeze, orange pour, mint crushed, black salt pinch. Close on her delighted face between inserts, 85mm.	VIKRAM And this is for the nights you want to feel fancy but wake up fresh. Virgin watermelon mojito. ఇదీ — ఫ్యాన్సీగా ఫీల్ అవ్వాలి, కానీ పొద్దున ఫ్రెష్ గా లేవాలి అనుకునే రొత్తరుఫ్ల కోసం. వర్జిన్ వాటర్ మెన్టో. RANI Virgin. వర్జిన్.

10.8 She repeats the word and covers her mouth, scandalised and giggling. He laughs too. CAMERA Two-shot, 50mm; both laughing.	VIKRAM That's what they call it! దాన్న్ అలాగే పిలుస్తారు!
10.9 She sips the whisky soda first. Grimaces. Sips again. The grimace softens. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, for the grimace and its melting.	RANI It burns. మండుతోందో. VIKRAM It's supposed to. Then it warms. మండాలి. తర్వాత వచ్చేదానిగా అవుతుంది.
10.10 She sips. Waits. Her hand drifts to her chest. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: her hand drifting to her chest.	RANI It's warming. వచ్చేదానిగా అవుతోంది.
10.11 LONG SEQUENCE, almost real-time. Two people on a terrace with the whole city glittering below them. She asks him about his childhood. He tells her about his father leaving when he was nine, about learning to cook Maggi at ten, about arriving in Hyderabad at nineteen with eight hundred rupees. Some of it is true. Some of it — we will later learn — is borrowed from other people's stories. CAMERA Two cameras: A-cam wide profile two-shot against skyline, 35mm; B-cam alternating CUs, 85mm. Dialogue here is improvised in Telugu by the actors within the beats given; capture 6–8 minutes, cut to ~3.	—
10.12 She tells him about the mango tree. The broom. That she was the one who told Amamma he was the thief. CAMERA Continue B-cam singles, 85mm.	VIKRAM You snitched? మీరు చాడీలు చాఫ్ పారా? RANI I was twelve. You were two. You had mango all over your face. అప్పుడు నాకు పన్నెండు. మీకు రెండు. మొహం నీండా మామిడి రసం.

10.13 A beat. The arithmetic of it hangs in the air. Twelve and two. Thirty-five and twenty-five. She looks away first. CAMERA Static wide two-shot, 35mm; hold the silence 4 seconds.	RANI I'm too old to be sitting here like this. ఇలా ఇక్కడ కూర్చోడొడొనొక్కొ నొకు వయసు ఎక్కొకువ. VIKRAM Like what? ఎలా? RANI Happy. సంతోషంగా.
10.14 He refills her glass — only soda this time. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: soda only into her glass.	VIKRAM You didn't get to be twelve properly. Or twenty. Or thirty. So you get them now. All at once. That's the rule of Club Penthouse. మీకు పనొండొళ్లు సరిగ్గా దక్కొకలేదు. ఇరవై కూడా. ముప్పొళ్లు కూడా. అందుకే ఇప్పుడు అనొనొ ఒక్కొసొరొ దక్కొకుతొయొ. అదొక్కొలబొ పొంట్లొ హొస్ రొల్.
10.15 She drinks the soda, eyes on him, and something unspoken passes. He breaks it with a joke. She lets him. CAMERA CU Rani over the rim of the glass, 85mm; reverse CU Vikram. End on a wide of two small figures and the city, 24mm.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

All "alcohol" is non-alcoholic substitute (cold black tea for whisky/rum, water for vodka). Herbal cigarettes only; ventilated set. Skyline as real background: shoot at blue hour for the first half, then deep night. Fairy lights are the key practical; add a soft 1x1 LED for faces. Health-warning captions in post. Long sequence can be covered with two cameras to keep real-time rhythm.

SCENE 11 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NEXT MORNING **NEW · ROMANCE**

Scene No.	11 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom	Story day, date & time	Day 11 · Thu 19 June · 09:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R5: grey cotton saree (slept in, rumpled) VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts		
Screen duration (approx.)	~4 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Breakfast tray: glass of lemon water, steel tumbler of buttermilk with salt and curry leaves, plate of two idlis with chutney; curtains (open, harsh sun), pillows, ceiling fan (practical, turning), Vikram's phone on bedside table		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
11.1 The First Hangover. Rani lies face-down on the bed, a pillow over her head, groaning at the sunlight. Vikram enters with a tray: lemon water, buttermilk with salt and curry leaves, two idlis. CAMERA Overhead, 24mm: Rani face-down, pillow over head, sun stripe across the bed. MS Vikram entering with tray, 35mm.	RANI (<i>muffled</i>) Close the curtains. Close the sun. Close Hyderabad. కర్టెన్లు వశేయండి. సూర్యుడిని మూసేయండి. హైదరాబాద్ ని మూసేయండి. VIKRAM Congratulations. Your first hangover. కంగ్రాట్స్. మీ మొదటి హ్యాంగోవర్. RANI Is this what he felt every morning? And still he drank every night? అతనికి రోజూ పొద్దున ఇలాగే ఉండేదా? అయినా రోజూ రాత్రి తాగేవాడా? VIKRAM Men are not very intelligent. మగవాళ్లకి తెలివీ కలంనా తక్కువ.

11.2 She laughs, then clutches her head because laughing hurts.

CAMERA MCU Rani, 50mm, peeking out from under the pillow.

RANI

Never again. I swear on Venkateswara Swamy. Never again.

ఇంకా ప్పుడూ తాగను. వాంకటేశ్వర స్వామి మీద ఒబ్బట్టు.

ఇంకా ప్పుడూ.

VIKRAM

Everyone says that. Swamy has heard it a lakh times.

అందరూ అదే అంటారు. స్వామి లక్షల సార్లు వినారా.

11.3 He sits, props her up against his shoulder, and holds the lemon water to her lips. She drinks. He presses two fingers to her temples and massages slowly. Her eyes close.

CAMERA Two-shot on the bed, 50mm, eye level. Insert, 100mm: fingers on her temples.

RANI

Where did you learn this?

ఇదో ఏక్కడ నేర్చుకున్నారో?

VIKRAM

Amma. Every time Nanna came home drunk, she did this for him. After he left, she did it for me when I had fever.

అమ్మ దగ్గర. నాన్న తాగి వచ్చినప్పుడల్లా అమ్మ ఇలాగే చేసేది. ఆయన వాళ్ళలోపలొక్క, నాకు జ్వరం వచ్చినప్పుడు నాకూ చేసేది.

RANI

Ten more minutes.

ఇంకో పది నిమిషాలు.

VIKRAM

Of what?

దేనికో?

RANI

Your hand. Don't move it.

మీ చేయి. తీయకండి.

11.4 He doesn't. She drifts back to sleep with her head in his lap. He looks down at her. A long, quiet hold as the ceiling-fan shadow passes over them both. His phone buzzes on the bedside table. For once, he lets it ring out.

CAMERA Overhead, 24mm: her head in his lap, fan shadow sweeping across both. Insert, 100mm: phone buzzing, unanswered, until it stops.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Bright, overexposed morning to sell the hangover: let the window blow out by 2 stops. Ceiling fan shadow is a hero element — position a hard source above the fan so its shadow sweeps across the bed. Keep the head-in-lap position modest and relaxed.

SCENE 12 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — AFTERNOON

Scene No.	12	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, closed bedroom door, narrow hall	Story day, date & time	Day 13 · Sat 21 June · 15:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R6: blue jeans and sleeveless red top, barefoot, hair loose (enters in R2 green saree) VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Rani's steel trunk open on bed, sarees stacked, newspaper-wrapped jeans with shop tag, red top, Vikram's apple, his phone (camera app), Bluetooth speaker, Vikram's second phone on counter		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
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12.1 Rani's steel trunk is open on the bed. Under the sarees, wrapped in newspaper, a pair of blue jeans with the shop tag still on, and a sleeveless red top. Vikram, leaning on the door frame, eating an apple.

CAMERA Overhead insert, 50mm: newspaper unfolding to the jeans and tag. MS Vikram in doorway, 35mm.

VIKRAM

You've been hiding those for how long?

మాటినో ఎన్ నాళ్లుగా దాచారు?

RANI

Sravya bought them for me with her scholarship money. Last Diwali. She said, "Amma, you're not dead, you're divorced." I haven't worn them even once.

శ్రావ్య తన స్కాలర్ షిప్ డబ్బులతో కొనాచోచోంది. పోయిన దీపావళికి. "అమ్మా, నువ్వో చచ్చిపోలేదు, వీడొక్కలు తీసుకున్నావో అంతే" అంది. ఒక్కసారి కూడా వేసుకోలేదు.

VIKRAM

Wear them.

వేసుకోండి.

RANI

Where? To go where?

ఎక్కడికి? ఎక్కడికి వెళ్లడానికి?

VIKRAM

To the hall. Then the terrace. Then the world.

హాలులోకి. తర్వాత టెర్రస్ కి. తర్వాత వరసంచలలోకి.

12.2 She pushes him out and closes the door. We stay outside with him. Long wait. He knocks.

CAMERA Hall side, 35mm: closed door, Vikram waiting. Hold for the long wait.

VIKRAM

Did you die?

బతికే ఉన్నారా?

RANI (O.S.)

I can't do the button.

బటన్ పాటటలేకపోతున్నా.

VIKRAM

Need help?

హెల్ప్ కావాలా?

RANI (O.S.)

Don't you dare.

లోపలికి వస్తే చూడండి!

12.3 The door opens. She stands there in the jeans and red top, arms crossed over herself, barefoot, hair loose for the first time in the film. She looks ten years younger and deeply uncomfortable.

CAMERA Reveal from Vikram's POV as the door opens, 50mm, eye level; tilt down to bare feet and back up.

RANI

Say something. No — don't say anything.

ఏదైనా చాప్ పండి. లేదు — ఏమీ చాప్ పకండి.

12.4 He doesn't say anything. He just looks. The look goes on too long. She uncrosses her arms slowly.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; reverse CU Rani; insert of arms uncrossing.

VIKRAM

Turn around.

ఒకసారి తిరగండి.

RANI

Why?

ఎందుకు?

VIKRAM

Phone photo. For Sravya. She paid for it, she should see.

ఫోన్ ఫోటో. శ్రావ్య కోసం. డబ్బు కట్టేందో తనో, తను చూడాలి కదా.

12.5 That lands. She stands straighter. He takes the photo. Then another. Then he puts on a song from his speaker — an upbeat Telugu item number — and starts dancing badly to make her laugh. She refuses. He dances worse. She laughs and, finally, moves a little, swaying, embarrassed, then less embarrassed. CAMERA Phone-screen POV insert of the photo being taken. Handheld 35mm for the dance, moving with them.	—
12.6 They end up dancing in the narrow hall, bumping into the couch, laughing. The song ends. They are close. Breathing hard. Neither moves away. CAMERA Tight two-shot, 50mm, as the music stops; hold on breath.	—
12.7 His phone — the second one — buzzes on the counter. He doesn't look at it. For once, he doesn't look at it. CAMERA Rack focus: buzzing phone on counter (foreground) to the two of them (background), 85mm.	RANI <i>(quietly)</i> Send the photo to Sravya. ఫోటో శ్చ రవ్వాకు పంపండో. VIKRAM Yeah. ఱి.
12.8 He steps back. The moment passes. But it is now known to both of them. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, from the terrace door: two figures stepping apart.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Wardrobe: jeans must be fitted for comfort and show the shop tag in the reveal (cut it off between takes per continuity log). Song for the dance must be cleared or composed; play back on set for rhythm. Keep the dance clumsy and joyful, not choreographed. Hair loose for the first time — note for hair continuity from here on.

SCENE 13 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT

Scene No.	13	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 15 · Mon 23 June · 23:45 to dawn
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R6: jeans and red top VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Bed, single remaining pillow (the last of the wall), two empty glasses carried in, AC (practical), sheer curtain that lifts in the AC draft, window with city skyline		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS

13.1 After another terrace evening. Two glasses in. They come in from the terrace laughing about something we missed, a little unsteady. She is still in the jeans. They each go to their side of the bed. The pillow wall is down to one pillow now.

CAMERA Handheld follow from the terrace door into the bedroom, 35mm. Overhead, 24mm (matching Scenes 3 and 8): one pillow now.

13.2 Lights off. Blue city light. They lie on their backs. This is the only interior-monologue passage in the film. The voices are soft, overlapping, almost whispered, each one panned to its own side of the frame.

CAMERA Mattress-level profile two-shot, 50mm, both faces in frame; hold static through the inner voices. Very slow push-in over the whole passage.

DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు

—

RANI (V.O., inner)

Sleep, Rani. Close your eyes. He's a boy. He's Shanta-garu's son. You bathed him once. You —

నోదోరపలో రాణీ. కళ్ళోలు మూసుకో. వాడు పోలీస్ లోడు. శాంత గారో కొడుకు. ఒకసారి వాడికి సోనానం కూడా చేయించాను. నువ్వో —

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)

Don't. Don't be stupid. She's here for a job. Two weeks. She'll go. వద్దు. పోచో చిపనో చేయకు. తను ఉద్యోగం కోసం వచ్చిందో. రౌండు వారాలు. వాళ్ళో లోపనోతుందో.

RANI (V.O., inner)

He listened to me. Nobody has listened to me since my father died.

అతను నా మాట వినకాడు. నానకనగారు పోయినాక నా మాట ఎవ్వరూ వినలేదు.

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)

She smells of coconut oil and whisky. That's — a terrible combination. Why is it working.

తన దగ్గర కొబ్బరినూనా, వీస్కీ వాసన వస్తోంది. అదీ — దారుణమైన కాంబినేషన్. అయినా ఎందుకు పని చేస్తోంది?

RANI (V.O., inner)

My hand is three inches from his hand. Three inches. I could move it by accident.

నా చేయి అతని చేతికి మూడు అంగుళాల దూరంలో ఉంది. మూడు అంగుళాలు. పొరపాటున కదిలించేయొచ్చు.

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)

If she moves, I'll know. If she doesn't, I'll leave it.

తను కదిలితే, నాకు అర్థమవుతుంది. కదలకపోతే, వదిలేస్తా.

RANI (V.O., inner)

What would Ammamma say.

అమ్మమ్మ ఏమంటుంది?

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)

What would Amma say.

అమ్మ ఏమంటుంది?

RANI (V.O., inner)

Ammamma drinks toddy on Sankranti.

అమ్మమ్మ సంక్రాంతికి కల్లు తాగుతుంది.

13.3 She laughs out loud, a small snort in the dark. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: the two hands, three inches apart on the sheet. Then back to the profile two-shot.	VIKRAM <i>(aloud)</i> What? ఏంటి? RANI <i>(aloud)</i> Nothing. ఏం లేదు. VIKRAM <i>(aloud)</i> You laughed. నవ్వారు. RANI <i>(aloud)</i> I was thinking about the toddy. కల్లు గురించి ఆలోచిస్తున్నా.
13.4 He laughs too. Then the laugh fades. Silence. The AC. The city. CAMERA Hold the two-shot; room tone only for 5 seconds.	RANI <i>(V.O., inner)</i> Now. If not now, never. You have waited your whole life for someone to ask. Nobody will ask. Ask. ఇప్పుడే. ఇప్పుడు కాకపోతే, ఇంకాపాడుకొను. ఎవరైనా అడుగుతారని జీవితమంతా ఎదురుచూశాను. ఎవ్వరూ అడగరు. నువ్వే అడుగు.
13.5 She picks up the last pillow from between them. Holds it to her chest for a moment, like a shield. Then she drops it on the floor. CAMERA MS Rani sitting up with the pillow, 50mm. Insert, 50mm: pillow landing on the floor (the wall is gone).	—

13.6 He turns his head to look at her. She is looking at him. CAMERA Matched CUs on the pillows, 85mm, eye-line across the bed.	RANI (<i>aloud, barely</i>) Is this wrong? ఇదో తప్పా? VIKRAM (<i>aloud</i>) Do you want it to be? తప్ప అవ్వాలనో మళ్ళీకుందా? RANI I don't know what I want. Nobody has ever asked. నాకేం కావాలో నాకే తెలియదు. ఎవ్వరూ ఎప్పడూ అడగలేదు. VIKRAM I'm asking. నేను అడుగుతున్నా.
13.7 A long, long beat. Her eyes fill. CAMERA ECU Rani's eyes, 100mm.	RANI Yes. అవును.
13.8 He reaches across. Touches her face. She leans into his palm and closes her eyes, and a tear runs into his hand. He kisses her forehead first. Then she pulls him closer. CAMERA CU, 85mm: her face leaning into his palm; tear running into his hand. Forehead kiss in a tight two-shot. Cut away the moment she pulls him closer.	—
13.9 CUT TO: the window. The city lights. The curtain lifting in the AC draft. A slow, long hold on the skyline as a soft song begins — a romantic Telugu melody, female vocals. The sounds of the room are lost under the music. Time passes in light changes on the city: midnight, two a.m., the first grey of dawn. CAMERA Locked-off from inside the window, 35mm: curtain lifting in the foreground, skyline beyond. Dissolve into the time-lapse plate (midnight → dawn).	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

CLOSED SET. Intimacy coordinator present; modesty garments; actors consent to each beat before rehearsal. The scene cuts away at the forehead kiss and the pull closer; nothing further is filmed. Inner voices are recorded separately as whispered V.O. and panned L/R in the mix. Time-lapse of the skyline (midnight → dawn) shot as a separate plate from the bedroom window.

SCENE 14 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — MORNING

Scene No.	14	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, then the unlit stove	Story day, date & time	Day 16 · Tue 24 June · 07:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R5: grey cotton saree, hastily wrapped VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Rumpled bedsheet, pillow on the floor (from Scene 13), cold stove, kadai, kitchen counter		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
14.1 Morning light. Rani wakes first. She sees where she is, sees him asleep beside her, and the full weight of it arrives. She sits up, pulling the sheet up, and stares at the floor. CAMERA CU Rani waking, 85mm, on the pillow. MS as she sits up, 50mm; her POV to the pillow on the floor.	—
14.2 She gets up quietly, wraps herself in a saree, goes to the hall, and stands at the stove without lighting it. Her shoulders start to shake. CAMERA Wide from the hall, 24mm: her back at the stove. Slow push-in to her shaking shoulders, 50mm.	—
14.3 Vikram wakes to an empty bed, finds her in the kitchen crying silently, her hand pressed to her mouth. CAMERA MS Vikram in bedroom doorway, 35mm; reverse onto her at the stove.	VIKRAM Rani. రాణీ. RANI Don't. Don't come near. Let me — let me just — వద్దు. దగ్గరకి రాకండి. నన్ను — నన్ను కాసేపు —

14.4 He stops a few steps away.

CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, the gap between them held.

RANI

I'm thirty-five. I have a daughter almost your — not almost. She's twenty. You're twenty-five. What am I?

నాకు ముప్పై ఐదు. దాదాపు మి వయసు — దాదాపు కొదు. నా కూతురొకరి ఇరవై. మికి ఇరవై ఐదు. నేనెంతటి?

VIKRAM

You're a woman who had one good night.

ఒక మంచి రాత్రి గడిపిన ఆడదామీరు.

RANI

I'm a mother.

నేను ఒక తల్లిని.

VIKRAM

You can be both.

రెండూ అవ్వొచ్చు.

RANI

In which village? In which family?

ఏ ఊరిలో? ఏ కుటుంబంలో?

VIKRAM

In this house. You said this was home.

ఈ ఇంట్లో. ఇదే ఇల్లు అన్నారాగ్గా.

RANI

You said.

అన్నదామీరు.

14.5 She turns to face him. Her eyes are red.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eye level; single uninterrupted take for the speech.

RANI

He never — in twenty years he never once asked me. Not once. It was like — like a chore. Like sweeping. Last night you asked me three times if I was okay. Three times. I didn't know a man could ask. And now I'm standing here feeling like the dirtiest woman in Andhra Pradesh, and I don't know if it's because of what we did or because I liked it.

అతను ఎప్పుడూ — ఇరవై ఏళ్లలో ఒక్కసారి కూడా నన్ను

అడగలేదు. ఒక్కసారి కూడా. అదొక — పనిలా. ఇల్లు

ఊడ్చినట్టు. నీళ్ల రాత్రో మీరు మూడు సార్లు అడిగారు నేను

బాగున్నానా అనీ. మూడు సార్లు. ఒక మగ్గుడు అడగడం నాకు

తొలియదు. ఇప్పుడు ఇక్కడ నీలబడి ఆంధ్రరదేశ్ మౌత్యంతలో

నేనే అతని మురికి అడదాననీ అనిపిస్తోందీ. అదీ మనం

చేసినదానీ వల్లం, లోక నాకు అదీ నచ్చలేదు వల్లం —

తొలియట్లేదు.

14.6 He crosses the distance. She lets him. He holds her face in both hands.

CAMERA Two-shot in profile, 50mm, as he crosses into her space; his hands frame her face.

VIKRAM

Listen to me. Nothing dirty happened in that room. You were taught that wanting is dirty. Your wanting is not dirty. Their hitting was dirty. Their dowry was dirty. You are the cleanest thing that has ever been in this flat — you literally cleaned it.

నా మాట వినండి. ఆ గదిలో మురికి ఏమీ జరగలేదు. కోర్కెవడం

మురికి అని మనకు నేర్పారు. మన కోరిక మురికి కాదు. వాళ్లు

కొట్టడం మురికి. వాళ్ల కట్నం మురికి. ఈ ఫ్లాట్ లో

ఇప్పటివరకు ఉన్నవాటిలో అతని శుభ్రమైనదే మేరే — అసలు

దీనిలో శుభ్రం చేసిందే మేరు.

14.7 She laughs through tears. Then cries harder. He pulls her into his chest. They stand in the kitchen, swaying slightly.

CAMERA Slow arc around the embrace, 35mm on slider.

RANI

What will we do?

ఇష్టమడేం చేద్దాం?

VIKRAM

Breakfast. Then whatever you want.

టెస్ట్. తర్వాత మనీషీం కావాలంటే అదే.

RANI

I don't know what I want.

నాకేం కావాలో నాకు తెలియదు.

VIKRAM

Then we'll find out. Every day, one thing.

అయితే కనుక్కందాం. రోజుకొకటి.

14.8 She pulls back and looks at him, searching his face for a lie. She doesn't find one. That's the tragedy: there isn't one visible.

CAMERA Her POV on Vikram's face, 85mm, held a beat longer than comfortable.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Morning-after: flat, cool daylight (no sun yet). Intimacy coordinator to approve the waking frames; Rani wears a slip under the sheet. Her crying at the stove is silent: no music until the embrace. Keep the stove unlit as a visual note.

SCENE 15 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE AFTERNOON **NEW · ROMANCE**

Scene No.	15 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — by the water tank, plastic chair	Story day, date & time	Day 17 · Wed 25 June · 17:00 to sunset
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree, hair loose VIKRAM — Costume V5: black hoodie, joggers		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Bottle of coconut oil warmed in the sun, plastic chair, small towel, hair comb, hair band for the braid		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
15.1 Oiling Her Hair. Rani sits on the terrace floor with a bottle of coconut oil warming in the sun. She is trying to oil her own hair and struggling to reach the back. CAMERA WIDE, 35mm, golden backlight; she is small against the water tank.	VIKRAM Give it. ఇవ్వండి. RANI You don't know how. మీకు రోదు. VIKRAM Teach me. Every day, one thing. నేర్పించండి. రోజుకొకటో అనుకున్నాం కదా.
15.2 He sits on the plastic chair. She sits on the floor between his knees, her back to him. He pours far too much oil into his palm. She laughs. CAMERA Frontal two-shot, 50mm: her face in front, his behind and above. Insert, 100mm: oil overflowing his palm.	RANI Too much love drowns them. పరమ ఎక్కువైతే మునగిపోతాయి. VIKRAM Plants. Not hair. అదో మౌక్ కలక. జుట్టుకొకటో కాదు.

15.3 He works the oil into her scalp, clumsy at first, then gentler. She closes her eyes.

CAMERA CU Rani's face, 85mm, eyes closing; his hands in soft focus in her hair.

RANI

My father did this. Every Friday. Before school. He would sing while he did it.

మా నాన్ నగారు ఇలా చేసేవారు. పాతా శుక్రవారం. బడికి
వాళ్ళ లోముందు. రాసా తా పాడేవారు.

VIKRAM

Ghantasala?

ఘంటసాల పాటలా?

RANI

Always. The last time was the morning of my wedding. He oiled my hair, and his hands were shaking, and he didn't sing. I asked why. He said, "From tomorrow someone else will do this, Rani." Nobody did. Nobody ever did.

ఎప్పుడూ అవే. చివరిసారి నా పాళ్ళలో రాజు పాడొద్దున. నానా
రాశారు, ఆయన చేతులు వణుకుతున్నాయో, పాడలేదు. ఎందుకు అనో
అడిగా. "రేపటి నుంచి ఇదో వేరే వాళ్ళు చేస్తారమ్మా"
అన్నారు. ఎవరూ చేయలేదు. ఎప్పుడూ ఎవరూ చేయలేదు.

15.4 Her shoulders shake. He keeps oiling, slower now. Then, badly and off-key, he hums the Ghantasala tune she was humming in Scene 4. She cries and laughs at once.

CAMERA Hold the frontal two-shot, 50mm; let the humming play in full.

RANI

You're killing that song.

ఆ పాటని చంపేస్తోతున్నారు.

VIKRAM

I'm a mango thief. Not a singer.

నేను మామిడికాయల దొంగని. సంగీతం కాదు.

15.5 He tries to braid her hair. It is a disaster, lopsided and loose. She feels it with her hand and laughs.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: clumsy fingers braiding; her hand feeling the lopsided result.

RANI

Sravya did better braids when she was six.

ఆరేళ్ళలోపడు శ్రావ్య ఇంతకంటే బాగా జడ వేసేదో.

VIKRAM

Then I'll practise. Every Friday.

అయితే పాఠాక్కట్నం చేస్తా. పాతా శుక్రవారం.

15.6 She turns and looks up at him. Something in her face opens completely. CAMERA CU Rani looking up, 85mm, low angle; reverse CU Vikram looking down.	RANI Promise? ప్రోమిస్? VIKRAM Promise. ప్రోమిస్.
15.7 He bends and kisses the parting of her hair. She holds his wrist against her cheek. The sun sets behind the water tank. Hold on the two of them in silhouette. CAMERA Wide silhouette against the sunset and water tank, 35mm, locked off; hold 10 seconds.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Golden hour into sunset; the final silhouette against the water tank is the hero frame — schedule the last beat for the exact sunset minute. Real coconut oil on hair: hair department to wash and reset between takes (allow 40 minutes). The braid should be genuinely lopsided; continuity of braids continues in Scene 16.

SCENE 16 MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — DAYS AND NIGHTS

Scene No.	16	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — kitchen, bedroom, terrace; building parking lot seen from the terrace rail	Story day, date & time	Days 18–26 · 26 June – 4 July · various; birthday night Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 22:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R10: montage set (kurti with jeans, floral dress, shorts in bedroom only, rain-soaked chiffon saree); R7: Vikram's hoodie over nightie (dawn); R11: mustard cotton saree (birthday) VIKRAM — Costume V6: montage set (T-shirts, rain-soaked linen shirt, kurta for the birthday)		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Pesarattu batter, tawa, burnt pesarattus; Royal Enfield in parking lot; red nail polish bottle; jasmine pot with first green bud; bedside lamp (to be knocked over, breakaway bulb); glasses; cigarette (herbal); Rani's phone; event fairy-light letters spelling HAPPY BIRTHDAY RANI (one letter flickering); small cake iced "RANI" with 36 candles; matchbox; knife and plate		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
16.1 A long montage over two songs, the first joyful, the second dreamy. The pillow wall is gone for good — we see it once, used as a backrest. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: the old pillow now propped as a backrest. Montage coverage mostly handheld 35mm with 85mm details.	—
16.2 Rani teaching Vikram to make pesarattu; he burns three; she eats the burnt ones. Vikram teaching her to ride the bike — no, just to sit on it in the parking lot of the building, which we only glimpse from the terrace rail; she screams with laughter when he revs it. She paints her toenails red on the bed, frowning in concentration. He paints one wrong and she smacks him with the bottle. Every Friday, a new lopsided braid — each one a little better. CAMERA Kitchen: two-shot at the tawa, 35mm. Bike: extreme high angle from the terrace rail looking down to the parking lot, 85mm compressed. Toenails: overhead insert, 100mm. Braids: a series of matched inserts of the back of her head, 50mm, one per Friday.	—

16.3 Rain on the terrace. They dance in it, she in a saree, soaked, hair stuck to her face, and he kisses her under the water tank. Her laughter echoes. The jasmine from Scene 5 shows its first green bud. CAMERA Rain towers; wide, 24mm, then 85mm under the tank for the kiss. Insert, 100mm macro: first green bud on the jasmine.	—
16.4 Nights: glasses on the bedside table, the bedside lamp clicked off by her hand — and then by his — and then the lamp knocked over and both of them laughing in the dark. Always the cut comes before anything is shown: a hand on a switch, the door pushed shut, the curtain falling. CAMERA Three matched inserts, 50mm: her hand on the lamp switch; his hand; the lamp tipping over. Black frames with laughter on the soundtrack.	—
16.5 She tries a cigarette alone on the terrace at dawn, wrapped in his hoodie, and holds it correctly now. She tries Western clothes one by one: a kurti with jeans, a dress he bought, a pair of shorts she refuses to wear past the bedroom door. In each, she is a little braver. CAMERA Dawn silhouette, 50mm, smoke catching first light. Wardrobe beats as a locked-off mirror shot, 35mm, same framing for each outfit (jump-cut).	—
16.6 A phone call. She takes it on the terrace, glowing. CAMERA MS Rani at the rail, 50mm; Vikram soft in the doorway behind.	SRAVYA (<i>V.O., on phone</i>) Amma, who took that photo? You look like a heroine! Kiran says you look like you're twenty-five. అమ్మా, ఆ ఫోటో ఎవరు తీశారు? హీరోయిన్ లా ఉన్నావా! నువ్వు ఇరవై ఐదేళ్ళ అమ్మాయిలా ఉన్నావని కిరణ్ అంటున్నాడు. RANI (<i>laughing, turning so Vikram can't see her blush</i>) A friend. A colleague. Study, Sravya. Fees are coming. ఒక ఫ్రెండ్. కాలిగ్. చదువుకో శర్వావయా. ఫీజు వస్తోంది.
16.7 She hangs up. Vikram is watching her from the doorway. He is not smiling. He is thinking. Then the smile comes back, quickly. CAMERA Rack focus from Rani (foreground) to Vikram in the doorway, 85mm, catching the unsmiling beat.	—

16.8 THE BIRTHDAY. Night. Rani comes out of the bathroom and the hall is dark. A single candle. Then he switches on a string of lights spelling HAPPY BIRTHDAY RANI (event stock, one letter flickering). A small cake. Thirty-six candles crammed onto it. CAMERA Wide from the bathroom door, 24mm: dark hall, one candle; lights snap on. Insert, 50mm: the flickering letter.	RANI How did you know? మీకాలా తెలిసింది? VIKRAM Your Aadhaar is on my laptop. You uploaded it to twenty-two job sites. మీ ఆధార్ నా లప్టాప్ టాప్ లో ఉంది. ఇరవై రెండు జాబ్ సైట్ లలో అప్ లోడ్ చేశారుగా.
16.9 She stares at the cake. Her hand trembles. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, lit by the 36 candles.	RANI I have never had a cake. నా జీవితంలో ఎప్పుడూ నా కోసం కేక్ లేదు. VIKRAM Never? ఎప్పుడూనా? RANI In the village, birthday is temple and payasam. After marriage, nothing. I made cakes for my children every year. Never one with my name. ఊర్ లో మట్టినరజంటే గుడ్డి, పాయసం. వాళ్ లయ్యాయాక ఏమీ లేదు. వారే ఏడా పిల్లలకి కేక్ చేశా. నా పేరుతో ఒక్కటూ కూడా లేదు.
16.10 She crouches by the coffee table and reads the icing letter by letter, like a child reading. CAMERA Insert, 100mm, her finger moving under each iced letter. Low angle, 50mm, her face at cake height.	RANI R. A. N. I. ఆర్ . ఏ. ఎన్ . ఐ. — రాణి.
16.11 She breaks down. Not from sadness. Something bigger. Thirty-six years of it. He kneels beside her and holds her while the candles drip wax onto the icing. CAMERA Two-shot on the floor, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: wax dripping onto the icing.	VIKRAM Make a wish before the cake catches fire. కేక్ కి నివ్వోపు అంటుకోకముందే ఏదైనా కోరుకోండి.

16.12 She closes her eyes. Wishes. Blows. Misses half the candles. He blows the rest. CAMERA CU Rani, eyes closed, 85mm; two-shot as both blow.	VIKRAM What did you wish? ఏం కోరుకున్నాను? RANI That this never ends. ఇదో ఎవ్ పట్టికో ముగియకూడదనో.
16.13 On his face: a flicker. Something that might be guilt, or might be satisfaction. The candle smoke rises between them. Hold. Cut. CAMERA CU Vikram through rising candle smoke, 85mm; hold 4 seconds; hard cut.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot as a 2-day montage block with a split unit (rain unit on terrace). Two songs (joyful, then dreamy) must be cleared or composed before shooting for rhythm. Bedroom beats always cut on a hand on a switch, a door or a curtain — intimacy coordinator present. Birthday cake: 3 identical cakes; candle wax fire-safety with extinguisher on set. The flickering letter is a practical fault built by art department.

SCENE 17 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT **NEW · ROMANCE**

Scene No.	17 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom	Story day, date & time	Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R11: mustard cotton saree, hair loose VIKRAM — Costume V6: kurta from the birthday		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Plate of leftover birthday cake in the middle of the bed, cake crumbs, pillows (for the pillow fight), bedside lamp (low), soft rain outside the window		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
17.1 Antakshari Night. Later the same night. Leftover cake on a plate in the middle of the bed. Soft rain outside. They sit cross-legged facing each other, playing antakshari. CAMERA Symmetrical two-shot from the foot of the bed, 35mm; cake plate centred between them.	VIKRAM Your letter is "ma". మ⁵ అక్షరం "మ".

17.2 Rani closes her eyes and sings a few lines of an old Ghantasala-era melody (production to clear rights for the chosen song). Her voice is unexpectedly beautiful, low and sure. He stares at her.

CAMERA Slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, as she sings; cut to CU Vikram staring.

VIKRAM

You can sing. You can actually sing.

మీరు పాడగలరు. నిజంగా పాడగలరు.

RANI

In the village I sang at every wedding. After my own, I stopped.

ఊర్ లో ప్రతి పండుగలోనూ పాడేదానో. నా పండుగలయ్యాక ఆపేశా.

VIKRAM

Why?

ఎందుకు?

RANI

He said a married woman singing loudly is calling men.

పండుగలయిన ఆడది గట్టెగా పాడితే మగాళ్లని పిలిచినట్టే అనాడు.

VIKRAM

Then sing loudly. Call me.

అయితే గట్టెగా పాడండి. నన్ను పిలవండి.

17.3 She laughs. His turn: he sings a recent dance number terribly, doing the hook step sitting down. She falls back on the bed laughing. Rounds pass in a quick sequence. He cheats; she catches him; a pillow fight scatters cake crumbs across the sheet.

CAMERA Handheld 35mm, loose and playful; jump-cut rounds. Overhead, 24mm, for the pillow fight and scattered crumbs.

—

17.4 Later. Lamp low. He lies with his head in her lap. CAMERA Overhead, 35mm: his head in her lap, matching Scene 11 with roles reversed.	VIKRAM Sing one more. Not a film song. Something only yours. ఇంకొక్కటా పాడండి. నీనామా పాట కాదు. మనీ ఒక్క కరొదే అయినదే. RANI There's a lullaby I sang to Sravya and Kiran. I made it up. Nobody else knows it. శ్రీరావ్‌యక్కో, కిరణ్ కి నేను పాడిన జోల పాట ఒకటే ఉందో. నేనే కట్టా. ఇంకొక్కవరకీ తెలియదు. VIKRAM Then I'll be the third. అయితే నేను మూడోవాడినో అమతా.
17.5 She strokes his hair and sings, barely above a whisper. The lullaby is original to the film. CAMERA CU Rani looking down, 85mm, lamp-lit; insert of her fingers in his hair.	RANI <i>(singing)</i> Moonlight on the terrace, come down slowly. Bring sleep to my little life. మేడ మేడ వాన్‌నాలా, మౌల్‌లగా దిగిరావే. నా చీన్‌నో పర్రాణానొక్కో నీదేదుర తెచ్చోచోవవో.
17.6 He falls asleep halfway through. She sings to the end anyway, very softly, looking down at his sleeping face. Her expression shifts: tenderness tipping into something close to fear of how much she feels. CAMERA Very slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, through to the end of the lullaby; hold her expression in silence after the last note.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The song Rani sings in the antakshari must be cleared or replaced with an original composition before the shoot; the lullaby is original to the film (music director to set the tune and record a guide). Live-record Rani's singing on set where possible. Pillow fight: feathers-free pillows.

SCENE 18 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — DAY / EVENING

Scene No.	18	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — counter and couch; Vikram's call on the terrace seen through the glass	Story day, date & time	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 09:00 (morning) and 18:30 (evening)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R2: green cotton saree (morning); R8: peacock-blue silk saree with zari border (evening) VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Laptop with another rejection email, Vikram's second phone (job listing on screen), counter stools, couch, Rani's keypad phone, Rani's handbag, offer letter in an envelope (Serenity Wellness Spa letterhead — fictional)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
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18.1 Morning. Rani at the laptop, dejected. Another rejection. Vikram, freshly showered, scrolls his phone at the counter — the second phone.

CAMERA Two-shot across the counter, 35mm; Rani at laptop foreground, Vikram on stool behind. Insert, 100mm: the second phone in his hand.

VIKRAM

Wait. Wait, wait. Listen to this. "Serenity Wellness Spa, Jubilee Hills. Hiring female therapists. No experience needed. Training provided. Salary twenty-five thousand plus incentives. Accommodation optional."

ఆగండి. ఆగండి ఆగండి. ఇదో వసీందో. "సరెనిటీ వువ్వెస్సా నౌస్ నౌస్, జూబిలీ హిల్స్. మహిళా థెరపిస్టులు కావాలి. అనుభవం అవసరం లేదు. ట్రైనింగ్ ఇన్ తాం. జీతం ఇరవై ఐదు వేలు ప్లస్ ఇన్సెంటివ్స్. వసతి ఆప్షనల్."

RANI

Spa? Like — massage?

స్పానా? అంటే — మసాజా?

VIKRAM

Ayurvedic. Head massage, foot reflexology, body oils. Ladies only, it says. Five-star clients. Film people. Tips in thousands.

ఆయుర్వేదీక. హెడ్ మసాజ్, ఫుట్ రిఫ్లెక్సాలజీ, బాడీ ఆయిల్స్. లెడీస్ మాత్రమే అని ఉంది. ఫైవ్ స్టార్ క్లెంట్స్. సినీమా వాళ్ళు. టిప్స్ వాలెస్.

RANI

I don't know massage.

నాకు మసాజ్ రాదు.

VIKRAM

You pressed Ammamma's legs every night for twenty years. You told me. That's ten thousand hours. That's an expert.

ఇరవై ఏళ్ళు ప్లస్ రౌటర్ అమ్మమ్మ కళ్ళు నొక్కకారు. మరీ చాప్ హారు. అంటే పదే వేల గంటలు. అదో ఎక్స్ పర్ట్ లెవెల్.

18.2 She laughs, doubtful. He is already dialling. He walks onto the terrace to talk. We stay inside with her. Through the glass, he is relaxed, laughing, too familiar with whoever is on the other end. She can't hear. We can, faintly.

CAMERA From inside, 50mm: Rani foreground soft, Vikram sharp through the glass door on the terrace. Hold; no cut outside.

VIKRAM (*O.S., muffled*)

Yes, Leela-akka, the one I told you about. ... Thirty-five, looks twenty-eight. ... Very shy. ... No, not yet. Slowly. ... Give me two weeks.

అమను లీల అక్కా, నేను చాప్ పని ఆవిడ. ... ముప్పై ఐదు, ఇరవై ఎనిమిదిలా కనిపిస్తుంది. ... చాలా సగ్గు. ... లేదు, ఇంకా లేదు. మౌలగ్గా. ... రౌండు వారాలు టైమ్ ఇవ్వమ.

18.3 He comes back in, beaming.

CAMERA MS Vikram re-entering, 35mm.

VIKRAM

Interview tomorrow, eleven a.m. I'll drop you.

రేపు పూర్వం పదకొండంటికి ఇంటర్వ్యూ. నేను డ్రాప్ చేస్తా.

RANI

Just like that?

ఇంత ఈజీగానా?

VIKRAM

I told you. Rich people need someone to arrange their happiness. Sometimes I arrange yours.

చాప్ పాను కదా. డబ్బునోళ్ల సంతోషానో ఎవరో ఒకరు ఏర్పాటు చేయాలి. అప్పుడప్పుడు మీ సంతోషం కూడా నేనే ఏర్పాటు చేస్తా.

18.4 EVENING. The door opens. Rani rushes in, still in her best silk saree, glowing. She grabs his hands and spins him in a circle in the tiny hall.

CAMERA WIDE from the hall, 24mm, as the door bursts open. Handheld 35mm spin with them.

RANI

I got it! I got it! Twenty-five thousand! Madam Leela said I have "healing hands". She said I have a — a kind face. Training starts Monday!

వచ్చేసిందా! వచ్చేసిందా! ఇరవై ఐదు వేలు! నావో "హీలింగ్ హ్యాండ్స్" అని లీల మేడమ్ అంది. నాదీ — మంచి మౌహం అంది. సోమవారం నుంచి ట్రైనింగ్!

18.5 He lifts her off the ground. She shrieks. He sets her down. CAMERA Low angle two-shot, 35mm, as he lifts her.	RANI Twenty-five thousand. Do you know what that is? Kiran's semester fee is forty-two. In two months — two months! — I can pay it myself. Not Amamma's land. Not anyone's loan. Me. ఇరవై ఐదు వేలు. అంటే ఏంటో తాలుసా? కిరణ్ సెమిస్టర్ ఫీజు నలభై రెండు వేలు. రెండు నెలల్లో — రెండే నెలల్లో! — నేనే కట్టేయొచ్చు. అమ్మమ్మ పొలం కాదు. ఎవరో అప్పు కాదు. నేను.
18.6 She sits on the couch, suddenly overwhelmed, and calls Amamma. We hear the old woman's voice crackle. CAMERA MCU Rani on the couch with the phone, 50mm.	AMMAMMA (<i>V.O., on phone</i>) Job? Real job? Ammaa, Venkateswara Swamy heard me. Who got it for you? ఉద్యోగమా? నిజమైన ఉద్యోగమా? అమ్మా, వంకటేశ్వర స్వామి నా మొర వినోనాడు. ఎవరు ఇప్పించారు? RANI (<i>looking at Vikram</i>) Vikram. Shanta-garu's son. పిక్రమ్. శాంత గారో అబ్బాయి. AMMAMMA (<i>V.O.</i>) That mango thief? Tell him I'll make him pulihora when you come home. Tell him he's a good boy. ఆ మామిడికాయల దొంగ? నువ్వమ్మ ఇంటికొచ్చినప్పుడు మామిడి పులిహోర చేస్తే పాడతానని చాపి. మంచి పిల్లలోడని చాపి.
18.7 Rani repeats it to him, laughing. Vikram smiles and looks away, out the window. Cut on his face. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, turning to the window; hard cut on his face.	RANI You're a good boy. మీరు మంచి పిల్లలోడట.

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The terrace phone call is played through the glass: record Vikram's side with a lav, mix it low and muffled so the audience only half-hears it. Spa name and letterhead are fictional; clear graphics. Evening light change between the two halves (practicals on, warm). Amamma's V.O. recorded with a phone-filter treatment.

SCENE 19

EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	19 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — dinner table under fairy lights	Story day, date & time	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 21:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R8 : peacock-blue silk saree (still in her best) VIKRAM — Costume V7 : white linen shirt, sleeves rolled, dark jeans		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Fairy lights, folding table with white event tablecloth, 2 candles, chicken biryani in foil containers, single red rose in an empty (de-branded) beer bottle, handwritten board "CONGRATULATIONS, THERAPIST RANI", Vikram's phone playing music, plastic chairs		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
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19.1 The Celebration Dinner. Rani steps out and stops. He has transformed the terrace: fairy lights, a folding table under a white event tablecloth, two candles, biryani in foil containers, a single rose standing in an empty beer bottle. A small handwritten board leans on the rail: CONGRATULATIONS, THERAPIST RANI.

CAMERA Her POV reveal, 24mm, slow dolly forward. Insert, 50mm: the handwritten board; insert, 100mm: rose in the bottle.

RANI

All this? For a job?

ఇదంతా? ఒక ఉద్యోగంకోసా?

VIKRAM

For your job. Your first salary. Your name on an offer letter.

మీ ఉద్యోగంకోసా. మీ మొదటి జీతానికోసా. ఆఫర్ లెటర్ మీద మీ పేరుకోసా.

RANI

In my whole life, nobody has celebrated anything I did. When Sravya came first in the district, they celebrated Sravya. When I learned to read English bills, nobody even noticed.

నా జీవితంలో నేను చేసిన దేన్నో ఏవో వరూ సెలబ్రేట్ చేయలేదు. శ్రావ్యకి జిల్లా ఫస్ట్ వచ్చినప్పుడు శ్రావ్యని సెలబ్రేట్ చేశారు. నేను ఇంగ్లీష్ బిల్లులు చదవడం నేర్చుకున్నప్పుడు ఎవరూ గమనించను కూడా లేదు.

VIKRAM

I noticed.

నేను గమనించా.

19.2 They eat with their hands from the same container. She feeds him a piece of chicken; he pretends it is too spicy and fans his mouth; she laughs. He plays an old romantic melody on his phone and holds out his hand.

CAMERA Two-shot across the table, 50mm, candles foreground. Insert, 100mm: her hand feeding him.

VIKRAM

Dance with me.

నాతో డాన్స్ చేయండి.

RANI

I don't know how. Not slow ones.

నాకు రోదు. ఇలాంటి స్లో డాన్సులు అసలు రోవు.

VIKRAM

Stand on my feet.

నా కాళ్ళ మీద నీలబడండి.

RANI

I'll break them.

వీరిగొప్పోతాయీ.

VIKRAM

Then I'll limp happily.

అయితే సంతోషంగా కుంటుతా.

19.3 She steps onto his feet, barefoot. They sway. She rests her forehead on his chest. The city glitters below.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: her bare feet stepping onto his. Slow 360° orbit on a track, 35mm, skyline wheeling behind them.

RANI (*softly*)

Vikram.

విక్రమ్.

VIKRAM

Hm?

ఊ?

RANI

Thank you. For the job. For everything. If not for you, I'd still be standing on Platform 14.

థాంక్ యూ. ఉద్యోగానికి. అన్యాయానికి. మీరు లేకపోతే నేనీంకా ప్లాట్ ఫామ్ పదనాలుగు మీదే నీలబడి ఉండేదాననీ.

19.4 He holds her closer and does not answer. Over her shoulder, his face: a flicker of something unreadable. Then he closes his eyes and keeps dancing. The song plays out over the dark city.

CAMERA CU Vikram over her shoulder, 85mm, the unreadable flicker. Crane up and away to a high wide of the terrace and skyline, 24mm.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Warmest look of the film so far: fairy lights + candles as key, soft LED bounce for faces. Real biryani, eaten with hands; keep hand-wash station nearby. The slow dance with her feet on his: rehearse for balance; she is barefoot. Song must be cleared. Hold the final skyline frame for the song's last bar.

SCENE 20 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT

Scene No.	20	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, bed and bedside table	Story day, date & time	Day 33 · Fri 11 July · 22:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree, hair tied up VIKRAM — Costume V8: bare back with a towel draped over it, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Spa training booklet (pressure-point diagrams, list of oils — fictional print), small bottle of coconut oil (rolls off the bed: practical), towel, bedside lamp, Vikram's second phone with message thread "L — Spa"		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
20.1 Rani has a training booklet from the spa: diagrams of pressure points, a list of oils. She sits on the bed reading it with her lips moving. Vikram lies face down on the bed with his shirt off and a towel over his back. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: booklet diagrams under her finger. MS two-shot, 35mm, from the foot of the bed.	VIKRAM Okay, therapist. Practise on me. సరే థెరపిస్ట్ గారూ. నా మీద ప్లెజర్ పాయింట్స్ చేయండి. RANI Practise on you? You're not a lady client. మీ మీదా? మీరు లేడీ క్లయింట్ కాదుగా. VIKRAM Pressure points are the same. Backs are backs. ప్లెజర్ పాయింట్స్ అందరికీ ఒకటే. వీపు వీపు.
20.2 She warms coconut oil between her palms. Hesitates over his shoulders. Begins. She is good — genuinely, instinctively good, from twenty years of tired elders. He groans. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: oil warming between her palms; hands hovering. High-angle MS over his back, 50mm.	VIKRAM Okay. Okay, you're actually good. సరే. సరే, మీరు నాజింగ్గా బాగా చేస్తోన్నారని. RANI Ammamma's knees. అమ్మమ్మ మోకాళ్ళల పుణ్యం.

20.3 She works in silence for a while, reading the booklet propped beside her. Her technique improves as we watch. Then he starts coaching — and the coaching is not only about technique.

CAMERA CU Vikram's face on the pillow, 85mm, eyes open and thinking while he coaches.

VIKRAM

And talk to them. Clients like it when you talk. Ask their name. Compliment something. "Your skin is so soft, madam." They're lonely. Rich people are lonely.

హాఫ్ లతో మౌట్ లాడండి కూడా. మౌట్ లాడితే క్లయింట్స్ కి నచ్చుతుంది. పేరు అడగండి. ఏదో ఒకటి పొగడండి. "మీ స్కాన్ ఎంత సాఫ్ట్ గా ఉంది మేడమ్." హాఫ్ లు ఒంటరి హాఫ్ లు. డబ్ బున్ హాఫ్ లు ఒంటరిగానే ఉంటారు.

RANI

I can't say that with a straight face.

అదీ సీరియస్ మౌహంతో చాప్ పలేను.

VIKRAM

Try. On me.

ట్రై చేయండి. నా మీదే.

RANI (*giggling*)

Your skin is so soft, sir.

మీ స్కాన్ ఎంత సాఫ్ట్ గా ఉంది సార్.

VIKRAM

Not funny. Serious. Low voice.

నవ్వు కూదు. సీరియస్ గా. మౌల్ లగా.

RANI (*lower, trying*)

Your skin is so soft.

మీ స్కాన్ ఎంత సాఫ్ట్ గా ఉంది.

20.4 The giggle dies. She means it. The oil, the lamp, the closeness. He turns over slowly and looks up at her. The training booklet slides off the bed.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, as the giggle dies. Insert, 50mm: booklet sliding off the bed.

VIKRAM

See? You make people feel things. That's the job.

చూశారా? మీరు మనుషులలో ఫీలింగ్స్ కలిగిస్తారు. అదే ఉద్యోగం.

20.5 She leans down and kisses him. The lamp is switched off by his hand. Cut to black on the sound of the oil bottle rolling off the bed and hitting the floor. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: his hand on the lamp switch. Black frame; sound of the bottle hitting the floor.	—
20.6 LATER. She is asleep. He is awake, sitting on the edge of the bed, texting on the second phone. The screen lights his face blue. A message thread with "L — Spa". We see his message, then it's gone: "Ready by month end. Trust me." CAMERA CU Vikram lit only by the phone, 85mm. Screen insert, 100mm: "Ready by month end. Trust me." Rack to Rani asleep, soft, behind him.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

CLOSED SET; intimacy coordinator present. Vikram is shot from the waist up on his back only; towel and track pants throughout. The scene cuts to black on the lamp switch. The phone message "Ready by month end. Trust me." is a screen insert (graphics), on screen for 2 seconds only.

SCENE 21 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT

Scene No.	21	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — couch in the dark; fridge with calendar; terrace and bathroom for the time-cut	Story day, date & time	Day 52 · Wed 30 July · 23:00 (time-cut runs to Day 59)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R9: spa uniform (lilac tunic and trousers) with handbag; R5 grey saree in the time-cut VIKRAM — Costume V9: navy T-shirt, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Wall calendar on fridge (dates crossed out; Kiran's fee date circled in red), spa uniform drying on terrace rail, row of oil bottles, framed photo of Sravya and Kiran on the shelf, Rani's handbag, glass with whisky-soda (cold tea), cash envelopes (prop currency, clearly marked), shower (bathroom) for the fully-clothed beat		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
21.1 Three weeks later. A calendar on the fridge has dates crossed out. The flat now has Rani's things everywhere: a spa uniform drying on the terrace rail, a row of oil bottles, a framed photo of Sravya and Kiran on the shelf. CAMERA Montage of inserts, 50–100mm: calendar, uniform on rail, oil bottles, framed photo.	—
21.2 Rani comes home late. Quiet. She doesn't switch on the light. She sits on the couch in the dark with her bag on her lap. Vikram comes out of the bedroom. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, from the terrace door: only street light through the glass. MS Vikram in the bedroom doorway, 35mm.	VIKRAM Why are you sitting in the dark? చీకట్లో ఎందుకు కూర్చున్నారో? RANI Leela madam called me into her room today. ఈ రోజు లీల మేడమ్ నన్ను తన రూమ్ కి పిలిచిందో.

21.3 He sits. Waits.

CAMERA Two-shot on the couch, 50mm, low key.

RANI

She said the regular clients are happy. Very happy. She said some of the madams want — more. Extra. She said it's "relaxation service". Private room. Double the money. Triple with tips.

రౌగ్ యులర్ క్ లయింట్ స హ్ యాపగ్ ఉన్ నారట. చాలా

హ్ యాపగ్. కొంతమంది మేడమ్ లకి — ఇంకా కూవాలట.

ఎక్స్ టర్. "రొలొక్ సేషన్ సర్వీస్" అంటారట. పర్సనల్ రూమ్. డబుల్ డబ్బు. టిప్స్ తో టర్నిషుల్.

VIKRAM (*carefully neutral*)

What kind of extra?

ఎలాంటి ఎక్స్ టర్?

21.4 Rani can't say it. She looks at the floor.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eyes down.

RANI

The kind that — that ladies don't do with ladies. In our village.

అలాంటిది — ఆడవాళ్లు ఆడవాళ్లతో చేయనీది. మా ఊరిలో.

21.5 A long silence.

CAMERA Hold the two-shot, 50mm.

VIKRAM

And what did you say?

మరేమనానా?

RANI

I said I'd think. I didn't want to lose the job. I came out and I was shaking at the bus stop. Why are you not angry?

ఆలోచిస్తాననా. ఉద్యోగం పోగొట్టుకోవాలని లోతు.

బయటకొచ్చి బస్ స్టాప్ లో వణికిపోయా. మరీకు కోపం

ఎందుకు రావటంలేదు?

VIKRAM

Because I'm thinking.

ఎందుకంటే నేను ఆలోచిస్తాననా.

RANI

Thinking what? She asked me to — with women — I'm not —

ఏం ఆలోచిస్తాననా? ఆవిడ నన్ను — ఆడవాళ్ళతో — నేను

అలాంటిదానని కాదు —

VIKRAM

Rani. Breathe. Come here.

రాణీ. ఊపిరి తీసుకోండి. ఇలా రండి.

21.6 He pours her a drink. Small peg, soda down the side of the glass. She takes it automatically. He sits beside her.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: soda poured down the side of the glass (exact echo of Scene 10). Two-shot, 50mm.

VIKRAM

Who are these women?

ఎవరు ఆ ఆడవాళ్ళు?

RANI

Rich. Lonely. Some husbands abroad, some husbands don't touch them. One cries during the head massage every time. She told me her husband hasn't looked at her in six years.

డబ్బున్నోళ్ళు. ఒంటరి వాళ్ళు. కొందరి భర్తలు

వదిలేశారే, కొందరి భర్తలు వాళ్ళని ముట్టుకోరు. ఒకావొడ హాడ్ మసాజ్ చేసిన పరతనారీ ఏడుసార్లు ఏడుస్తోంది. ఆరేళ్ళుగా భర్త తన వైపు చూడలేదని చాఫ్ పోంది.

VIKRAM

And you know what that feels like.

అదీ ఎలా ఉంటుందో మీకు తెలుసు.

21.7 She looks at him.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; reverse CU Vikram, 85mm, through the persuasion that follows (keep him half in shadow).

VIKRAM

Twenty years nobody asked what you wanted. These women are paying someone to ask. You're the one who knows how to ask. You learned it here. With me.

ఇరవై ఏళ్లు మీకేం కావాలో ఎవ్వరూ అడగలేదు. ఈ ఆడవాళ్లు ఎవరైనా అడగాలని డబ్బు కడుతున్నారు. ఎలా అడగాలో తెలిసిందో మీకే. ఇక్కడే నేర్చుకున్నారు. నాతో.

RANI

That was love.

అదో ప్రేమ.

VIKRAM

And this is care. Paid care. Nurses touch bodies. Doctors touch bodies. Nobody calls them names. It's the same skin.

ఇదో సంరక్షణ. డబ్బు తీసుకునే సంరక్షణ. నర్సులు ఒంటిని ముట్టుకుంటారు. డాక్టర్లు ముట్టుకుంటారు. వాళ్లని ఎవరూ తీట్టరు. అదే చరమం.

RANI

It's not the same.

అదో ఒకటో కాదు.

VIKRAM

It's not. It's better paid.

కాదు. దీనికే డబ్బు ఎక్కువ.

21.8 She almost laughs, then doesn't. He takes her hand.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: his hand taking hers.

VIKRAM

I'm not saying do it. I'm saying don't decide from your mother-in-law's mouth. Decide from yours. You said yes to me after thirty-five years of no. You know how to say yes now. You also know how to say no. Both are yours.

చేయమనో ననేను చాఫ్ పట్టలేదు. మనీ అత్త తగారో నోటోత్తో

నోర్ ఇయించకండి అంటున్నా. మనీ నోటోత్తో నోర్ ఇయించండి.

మువ్ పై ఐదేళ్ల "వద్దు" తర్వాత నాకు "సరే" అన్నారా.

ఇవ్వుడు "సరే" అనడం మనీకు తెలుసు. "వద్దు" అనడం కూడా తెలుసు.

రౌండ్లా మనీవే.

21.9 She drinks. Long silence.

CAMERA Hold two-shot, 50mm.

RANI

Kiran's fee is due in nineteen days.

కొరణ్ ఫీజు కట్టడానొక ఇంకా పంతామ్ మిదో రోజులతో ఉందో.

VIKRAM

I know.

తెలుసు.

RANI

How do you know?

మనీకాలా తెలుసు?

21.10 The tiniest pause.

CAMERA Tight CU Vikram, 85mm, one beat.

VIKRAM

You crossed it on the calendar. In red.

క్యాలెండర్ మనీద ఎరర్ పాన్ తో మార్క్ చేశారుగా.

21.11 She looks at the calendar. It's true. She nods slowly. CAMERA Her POV: calendar on the fridge, red circle, 50mm push-in.	RANI Only ladies. అమ్మమ్మ మాత్రమే. VIKRAM Only ladies. And if anything feels wrong, you walk out and call me. I'll be downstairs in fifteen minutes. Every time. అమ్మమ్మ మాత్రమే. ఏదైనా తప్పుగా అనిపిస్తే, బయటకొచ్చి నాకు ఫోన్ చేయండి. పదిహేను నిమిషాలలో కింద ఉంటా. పోతాను.
21.12 She leans her head on his shoulder. He strokes her hair. His eyes are open, fixed on the dark window, and his reflection in the glass looks like a different man. CAMERA Shoot into the dark terrace glass, 50mm: the couple in the foreground soft, Vikram's reflection in the glass sharp.	—
21.13 TIME CUT — a week of nights, a brief sequence. Rani coming home later and later. Cash in envelopes placed on the counter. The red circle on the calendar crossed out: PAID. She calls Kiran; we hear only his joyful voice from the phone. CAMERA Matched-frame sequence, 35mm locked off on the front door: she enters at later clock times (insert of wall clock). Insert, 100mm: envelopes on counter; "PAID" written over the red circle.	KIRAN (V.O., on phone) Amma, thank you! అమ్మా, థాంక్స్!
21.14 She cries happy tears on the terrace. She also, once, sits under the shower fully clothed for a long time. He watches from the doorway and says nothing. CAMERA MS on the terrace, 50mm. Bathroom: high angle through the shower glass, 35mm, Rani clothed under the water; reverse on Vikram in the doorway, 85mm.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Prop money must be printed "FOR FILM USE ONLY". Calendar is a hero continuity prop through Scenes 21–28 (red circles, crossings, PAID): art department to keep a dated master. Shower beat: warm water, wardrobe double of R5, quick change and heater for the actor. Kiran's V.O. is one line, recorded with phone filter.

SCENE 22

INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — SUNDAY, RAIN ALL DAY

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	22 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 56 · Sun 3 August · 11:00–16:00 (rain all day)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R12 : Vikram's oversized black T-shirt and cotton pyjamas VIKRAM — Costume V9 : navy T-shirt, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Tangled sheets, bowl of roasted peanuts, 2 cups of his tea, ballpoint pen (blue, skin-safe ink), rain on the window (rain bar outside)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
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22.1 A Sunday in Bed. The spa is shut. Rain on the window all day. A tangle of sheets, a bowl of roasted peanuts, two cups of his terrible tea. Rani in his oversized T-shirt and cotton pyjamas; neither of them has dressed properly. She lies with her head on his chest.

CAMERA Overhead, 24mm: two figures in tangled sheets, peanut bowl, tea cups; rain shadows on the sheet from the window.

RANI

Have you seen the sea?

మీరు సముద్రం చూశారా?

VIKRAM

Goa. For an event. Why?

గోవాలో. ఒక ఈవెంట్ కోసం. ఎందుకు?

RANI

I have never seen it. Thirty-six years. Vizag is four hours from our village, and I have never seen the sea. He went every year with his friends.

నేను ఎప్పుడూ చూడలేదు. ముప్పై ఆరేళ్లు. మా ఊరి నుంచి వైజాగ్ నాలుగు గంటలే, అయినా సముద్రం చూడలేదు. అతను పోరత ఏడా ఫోరండ్స్ తో వాళ్లతోపాడు.

VIKRAM

What do you think it looks like?

అది ఎలా ఉంటుందని అనుకుంటున్నారా?

RANI

Like the terrace sky. But lying down. And moving. And never tired.

మన టెరస్ ఆకాశంలా. కానీ పడుకుని ఉంటుంది. కదులుతూ ఉంటుంది. ఎప్పుడూ అలసిపోదు.

22.2 He takes a pen from the bedside table, opens her palm, and draws: a small house with a flat roof, a stick-figure plant on top, wavy lines in front. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro, top-down on her open palm as the ink house is drawn line by line.	VIKRAM Our house. In Vizag. Beach Road. Terrace on top. Jasmine. And this — the sea. You'll wake up and the first thing you see is water. మన ఇల్లు. వైజాగ్ లో. బీచ్ రోడ్. పైన టెర్రస్. మల్లా మౌక్. ఇదీ — సముద్రం. మీరు లేవగానే మౌదట నీళ్లతో కనీసోతాయ్. RANI And the children? మరో పిల్లలు? VIKRAM <i>(adding tiny figures)</i> Sravya's room. Kiran's room. Amamma on the ground floor because of her knees. శ్రీరావ్ రూమ్. కిరణ్ రూమ్. మౌకాఫ్ల వల్ల అమ్మమ్మ కింద ఫ్లోర్ లో.
22.3 She laughs, then looks at the drawing for a long time. CAMERA CU Rani looking at her palm, 85mm.	RANI Don't say things like this if you don't mean them. I'm too old to wash dreams off my hand. మనసులో లేకపోతే ఇలాంటి మాటలు అనకండి. చేతి మీదో కలలు కడుక్కొనే వయసు కాదు నాదో. VIKRAM Then don't wash it. అయితే కడక్కండి.
22.4 She closes her fist around the ink drawing and holds it against her chest. She settles back against him. The rain goes on. A long hold on her closed fist. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her fist closing over the drawing, held to her chest. Long hold; rain sound only.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Soft, grey all-day light: large diffusion outside the window, rain bar on the glass. The palm drawing is done by make-up in skin-safe ink; photograph the drawing for continuity (faint smudge in Scene 32). Keep both actors fully clothed; relaxed, domestic intimacy only.

SCENE 23 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT

Scene No.	23	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom: door, floor against the wall, the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 63 · Sun 10 August · 23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R13: plum cotton saree, handbag VIKRAM — Costume V9: navy T-shirt, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Rani's handbag (thrown at wall — soft breakaway contents), bed, bedroom wall, door that slams		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
23.1 Rani storms in, slams the door, throws her bag at the wall. Vikram sits up in bed. CAMERA WIDE from the bed, 24mm: door slams, bag hits wall. Quick insert of bag contents spilling.	RANI Men. మగ్గోళ్లు. VIKRAM What? ఏంటి? RANI Men! Leela madam says from next week, men also. "Couples' packages" first, she says, then "gentlemen only". She says the money is five times. She says the girls who said no are gone. She says she'll give my slot to someone younger. మగ్గోళ్లు! వచ్చే వారం నుంచి మగ్గోళ్లు కూడా అంటోందో లీల మేడమ్. ముందు "కపుల్స్ ప్యాకేజీలు", తర్వాత "జెంటిల్ మన్ ఓన్లీ" అంటుంది. డబ్బు ఐదు రెట్లు అంటుంది. వద్దన అమ్మాయిలు ఇవ్వమని అంటుంది. నా స్లాట్ ఇంకా వర్తమానా చీఫ్ పోలీస్ ఇచ్చేస్తానంటోంది.

23.2 She is pacing.

CAMERA Handheld MS following her pacing, 35mm.

RANI

I said I'm not that kind of woman. You know what she said? She laughed. She said, "Vikram said you'd say that."

నేను అలాంటి ఆడదానో కాదనా. ఆవిడేమందో తెలుసా?

నవ్వింది. "నువ్వేమ అలాగే అంటావని విక్రమ్ ముందే చెప్పాడు" అంది.

23.3 Silence. He goes very still.

CAMERA Locked-off CU Vikram, 85mm; the handheld energy stops dead.

RANI

Why does she know your name?

ఆవిడకి మీ పేరు ఎలా తెలుసు?

VIKRAM (*smoothly*)

Because I'm the one who called her for the interview. Everyone in this industry knows everyone. I do her events. Her Diwali party. Her spa launch.

ఎందుకంటే ఇంటర్వ్యూ కోసం ఫోన్ చేసింది నేనే. ఈ

ఇండస్ట్రీలో అందరికీ అందరూ తెలుసు. ఆవిడ ఈవెంట్స్ నేనే చేస్తా. దీపావళి పార్టీ. సోపా లాంచ్.

RANI

And you told her what I'd say?

నేనేమంటానో ఆవిడకి మీరు చెప్పారా?

VIKRAM

She asked what you're like. I said you're a good woman who will say no to everything at first. Because you were trained to. I said it as a compliment.

మీరాలంటే హాఫ్ లనో అడిగింది. మొదట వ్యతిరేకంగా "వద్దు"

అనే మంచి మనిషి అని చెప్పా. ఎందుకంటే మీకు అలాగే

నేర్పారు. పొగడ తగినా చెప్పా.

23.4 She stares at him, wanting to believe it. She does believe it. That is what we are watching: her deciding to believe it.

CAMERA Slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, across 6 seconds of silence.

RANI

I won't do it.

నేను చేయను.

VIKRAM

Then don't.

అయితే చేయకండి.

RANI

Then I lose the job.

అప్మడు ఉద్యోగం పోతుంది.

VIKRAM

Then you lose the job.

అయితే పోనీవ్వండి.

RANI

And Sravya's final-year fee, and the hostel, and Kiran's laptop, and Ammamma's knee surgery —

మరి శ్రీరావు షైన్ లా ఇయర్ ఫీజు, హాస్టల్, కిరన్ లాప్ టాప్, అమ్మమ్మ మోకాలి ఆపరేషన్ —

VIKRAM

I know.

తెలుసు.

23.5 She sits on the floor against the wall. Puts her face in her knees.

CAMERA High angle, 35mm, Rani small against the wall.

RANI

Why does every road in my life end at a man's body?

నా జీవితంలో ప్రతి దారికీ ఒక మగ్గాడి ఒంటి దగ్గరే ఎందుకు ముగుస్తోంది?

23.6 He sits on the floor beside her. Doesn't touch her yet.

CAMERA Floor-level two-shot, 50mm, both against the wall.

VIKRAM

You know what the difference is? Before, men took. Your husband took. His family took. Now you set the price. You decide. You walk out with the money. That's not the same road. That's the opposite road.

తేడా ఏంటో తెలుసా? ఇంతకు ముందు మగళ్ళు లాక్కునారు. మనీ భర్త లాక్కునాడు. అతని కుటుంబం లాక్కుంది. ఇప్పుడు రేటు మనీరు నర్ణయిస్తారు. మనీరే నర్ణయిస్తారు. డబ్బుతో మనీరు బయటికి నడుస్తారు. అదే అదే దారి కాదు. మార్గతగా ఎదురు దారి.

RANI

It looks the same from the inside.

లోపల నుంచి చూస్తే రెండూ ఒకేలా ఉంటాయి.

23.7 He has no answer for that. For a long time, neither speaks. Then, softly:

CAMERA Hold the floor two-shot; 8 seconds of silence.

VIKRAM

If you want, we'll practise. So it's not strange. So nothing surprises you. So you're the one in control.

మనీకు కావాలంటే ప్రాక్టీస్ చేద్దాం. వంతగా అనవసరం కాదు. ఏదీ షాక్ ఇవ్వకుండా. కంట్రోల్ మనీ చేతిలో ఉండాలి.

RANI

Practise what?

ఏం ప్రాక్టీస్?

VIKRAM

How to say no to the things you don't want. How to stop a man's hand without making him angry. How to keep your face calm. How to end a session. I've watched a hundred of these men at events. I know how they talk. Let me be them. You handle me.

మనీకు ఇష్టం లేనిదానికి "నో" ఎలా అనాలి. కోపం రాకుండా ఒక మగాడి చేతని ఎలా ఆపాలి. మౌనం వర్ణాంతంగా ఎలా ఉంచాలి. సాఫ్ట్ ఎలా ముగించాలి. ఈవెంట్లలో ఇలాంటి వందల మందిని చూశా. వాళ్ళు ఎలా మాట్లాడతారో తెలుసు. నేను వాళ్ళలా ఉంటా. మనీరు నన్ను హ్యాండ్లర్ చేయండి.

23.8 She looks at him. Long, searching. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm.	RANI You'd do that? Pretend to be one of them? మీరు అలా చాఫ్ తారా? వాఫ్ లలో ఒకరిలా నటాఫ్ తారా? VIKRAM I'd do anything to keep you safe. మీమ్ మలన్ సాఫ్ గా ఉంచడానొక ఏమైనా చాఫ్ తా.
23.9 PRACTICE SESSION. This is played as a disturbing role-play, not as romance. He sits on the bed and becomes a client: loud, entitled, pushy. CAMERA Cold top light switches on. Low angle on Vikram as "client", 35mm, making him loom.	VIKRAM (<i>as client</i>) How much for the full service, madam? ఫుల్ సర్వీస్ కి ఎంత మడమ్?
23.10 She freezes. He drops character. CAMERA CU Rani frozen, 85mm.	VIKRAM Breathe. Say the menu. Say no to what's not on it. ఊహరి తీసుకోండి. మనూ చాఫ్ పండి. మనూలో లెనోదానొక "వదోదు" అనండి.
23.11 Again. She tries, voice trembling. Again. Steadier. He grabs her wrist as the client. She panics. He drops character, calms her, teaches her to twist free and smile. Again. Again. She gets better. Each round, she is less herself. CAMERA Repetition in matched frames, 50mm, jump-cutting between rounds. Insert, 100mm: his grip on her wrist (the grip that returns in Scene 26). Her face grows more composed and emptier each round.	—
23.12 At the end she is shaking, and he holds her, and the role-play dissolves into the two of them again. She clings to him as if he is the only safe body in the city. The camera pulls back, slowly, through the bedroom door, into the dark hall, until they are small in the frame. Cut. CAMERA Dolly pull-back, 35mm, from the embrace through the doorway into the dark hall; 20-second move; cut.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The role-play is staged as disturbing, not romantic: cold, flat top light, no score. Intimacy and stunt coordinators to choreograph the wrist-grab and twist-free; padded wristband under the sleeve. CLOSED SET. No physical contact beyond what is rehearsed. Final pull-back through the doorway on a dolly.

SCENE 24 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN

Scene No.	24	INT / EXT	EXT / INT
Location	Penthouse terrace rail; bedroom through the glass door; bathroom door	Story day, date & time	Day 64 · Mon 11 August · 05:45
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R7: Vikram's grey hoodie over cotton nightie VIKRAM — Costume V9: navy T-shirt (asleep)		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Cigarette (herbal) and lighter, Rani's phone, terrace rail (cigarette stubbed out on it), bed, bathroom tap (running at full force)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
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24.1 Rani alone on the terrace in his hoodie, a cigarette held properly now. Her phone rings. Sravya.

CAMERA Profile MS at the rail, 50mm, dawn sky behind; insert, 100mm: phone screen "Sravya".

SRAVYA (*V.O., on phone*)

Amma, are you sleeping? Sorry, sorry. I couldn't wait. The college sent the final-year notice. Placement training fee, exam fee, and the industrial tour — total is one lakh eighteen thousand. By the fifteenth. I'm sorry, Amma. I'll do tuitions. I'll —

అమ్మా, నోడర్ పోతున్నావా? సారీ సారీ. ఆగలేకపోయా. కాలేజీ ఫైనల్ ఇయర్ నోటీస్ పంపింది. ప్లేస్మెంట్ మంట్ ట్రైనింగ్ ఫీజు, ఎగ్జామ్ ఫీజు, ఇండస్ట్రీయల్ టూర్ — మొత్తం లక్ష పదిహేనేని వేలు. పదిహేనో తారీఖు లోపు. సారీ అమ్మా. నేను ట్యూషన్లు చూపతా. నేను —

RANI

Don't do tuitions. Study.

ట్యూషన్లు వద్దు. చదువుకో.

SRAVYA (*V.O.*)

You sound tired.

అలసపోయినట్టున్నావ్.

RANI

City air.

సీటీ గాలి.

SRAVYA (*V.O.*)

Amma — are you happy there?

అమ్మా — అక్కడ నువ్వే సంతోషంగా ఉన్నావా?

24.2 Rani looks back through the glass door. Vikram asleep on the bed, one arm flung over her empty side.

CAMERA Her POV through the glass door, 85mm: Vikram asleep, arm across her empty side.

RANI

I'm — something. I'll pay it. By the tenth. Don't worry.

నేను — ఏదోలా ఉన్నా. కట్టెపోతా. పది తారీఖు లోపు.

కంగారు పడకు.

24.3 She hangs up. Smokes the cigarette down to the filter. Stubs it out on the rail. Goes inside. Shakes Vikram awake.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: cigarette stubbed on the rail. Handheld follow inside, 35mm.

RANI

Tell Leela madam yes.

లీల మేడమ్ కి సరే అని చూపండి.

24.4 He opens his eyes. Doesn't smile. Nods. She walks into the bathroom and shuts the door. We hear the tap run, full force, to cover something. Hold on him alone in the bed — and then, very slowly, the corner of his mouth lifts. Cut.

CAMERA Locked-off CU Vikram on the pillow, 85mm; hold through the tap sound until the corner of his mouth lifts; hard cut.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Dawn: shoot the call in the 20 minutes before sunrise; cool blue ambience, no fill. Sravya's V.O. recorded with phone filter. The final hold on Vikram's mouth lifting is the act-ending image: lock off, let the tap sound run under it.

SCENE 25 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT

Scene No.	25	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom (wardrobe panel), hall, front door and dark corridor	Story day, date & time	Day 67 · Thu 14 August · 23:20–23:50
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R14: faded orange cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V10: towel at waist after shower, hair wet		
Screen duration (approx.)	~15 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Vikram's second phone (message preview graphic), the ledger (hero prop: dated pages, two columns "L" and "V", crossed-out names, Rani's page with weekly entries in changing ink colours), rubber band, plywood panel, bed pulled out, Rani's steel trunk, sarees, jeans, red top, framed photo of Sravya and Kiran, Rani's purse, front door, rain in the corridor/stairwell		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
25.1 Vikram is in the shower. His second phone rings on the bed. Once. Twice. Rani, folding clothes, glances at it. "L — Spa". It stops. A message preview slides in: "Rani's Saturday booking confirmed. Hotel, room 412. Client paid 40 advance. Your 60% as usual. Good work, Vikku." CAMERA MS Rani folding clothes, 35mm, phone in the foreground buzzing. Insert, 100mm: caller ID, then the message preview (screen graphic, held long enough to read).	—
25.2 She reads it again. Again. She does not understand the words, and then she understands all of them at once. Her hand goes cold on the phone. CAMERA ECU, 100mm: her eyes reading the screen, left-right, again. CU of her hand going still on the phone.	—
25.3 She goes to the wardrobe. Pulls the bed out. Opens the plywood panel. Takes out the ledger book with the rubber band. Sits on the floor and opens it. CAMERA Handheld, 35mm, urgent: bed dragged, panel pulled. Low angle from inside the hidden shelf as her hand reaches for the ledger (callback to Scene 9).	—

25.4 INSERT: pages of names — only first names, women's names — with dates, amounts, two columns: "L" and "V". Some names crossed out. Some with notes: "village", "widow", "husband abroad", "runaway". And on the most recent page, in his neat handwriting, her name. RANI. The first entry is the date she arrived. Note beside it: "Arrived. Very shy. Divorced. Two kids, fees. No family in city. 4–6 weeks." CAMERA Top-down inserts, 100mm macro, page by page; slow pan along a column of names. Stop on RANI and the arrival date.	—
25.5 She turns the page. Under her name, line by line, the weeks of her life: "Week 1 — trust. Cleaning, cooking. Let her talk." "Week 2 — drinks. Smoking. Freedom talk." "Week 3 — physical. Make her feel wanted." "Week 4 — L interview. Ladies first." "Week 6 — men. Practice. Kids' fees = lever." CAMERA Insert, 100mm: each line revealed as her finger moves down; ink colour visibly changing line to line. Intercut CU Rani reading, 85mm.	—
25.6 The shower stops. She doesn't move. He comes out in a towel, hair wet, whistling. Sees her on the floor with the book. The whistle dies. CAMERA Wide from the bathroom door, 24mm: Rani on the floor with the ledger in the foreground; Vikram enters background and stops.	—
25.7 A silence so long the AC sounds deafening. CAMERA Hold the wide; AC hum raised in the mix.	RANI (<i>very quietly</i>) "Kids' fees equals lever." "పిల్లల ఫీజు సమానం లీవర్."

25.8 He doesn't speak.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, frozen.

RANI

What is a lever, Vikram? I studied till ninth class. Explain it to me.

లీవర్ అంటే ఏంటి పోర్మ? నేను తొమ్మిదో తరగతి వరకు చదివా. నాకు ఆర్థమయ్ యేలా చూపా.

VIKRAM

Rani, put that down.

రాణీ, అది కింద పోట్టు.

RANI

A lever is something you use to move a heavy thing that won't move by itself. Physics. Eighth class. I remember. My children are your lever.

తనంతట తాను కదలని బరువైన దానోని కదిలించడానికొ పాడేదో లీవర్. ఫిజిక్స్. ఎనిమిదో తరగతి. గుర్తుంది. నా పిల్లలు నీ లీవర్.

25.9 She stands up. The book in her hand.

CAMERA Low angle, 35mm, as she rises into frame holding the ledger; he is now smaller.

RANI

"Arrived. Very shy." The first day. Before I even came inside. Before you said "feel like home". You wrote this the first day.

"వచ్చింది. చాలా సగ్గు." మొదటి రోజు. నేను లోపలికి రాకముందే. "మీ ఇల్లు అనుకోండి" అనకముందే. మొదటి రోజు ఇదో రాశామ.

VIKRAM

I wrote it later.

తర్వాత రాశా.

RANI

The ink is different every week! You wrote it every week! While I was cooking for you, you were writing the next week!

పోరతి వారం ఇంకు వేరేగా ఉంది! పోరతి వారం రాశామ! నేను నీకు వండి పాడుతుంటే, నువ్వు తర్వాత వారం ఏం చేయాలో రాసుకుంటున్నామ!

25.10 She throws the ledger at him. It hits his chest and falls open on the floor. CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm; insert of the ledger landing open on the floor (soft-weighted dummy).	RANI Who are you? అసలు నువ్వోవోవరు?
25.11 And now, for the first time, he stops performing. He picks up the ledger, closes it, puts the rubber band back on. Calm. That calm is the most frightening thing in the film. CAMERA Static MS, 50mm, eye level; let the calm action play in real time. Insert, 100mm: rubber band snapped back on.	VIKRAM You know who I am. I'm the one who listened. Everything I said was true. ననేనావరో నీకు తెలుసు. నీ మాట వాస్తవవాడని. నేను చాప్ పొందంతా నీజమే. RANI You're a — a — నువ్వోమ ఒక — ఒక — VIKRAM Say it. Pimp. It's just a word. Event manager is also just a word. I arrange people's happiness. That part was never a lie. అనోయ్. బోరోకర్. అదో ఒక మాట అంతే. ఈవెంట్ మేనేజర్ కూడా ఒక మాటే. నేను జనం సంతోషానో ఏర్పాటు చేస్తా. ఆ మాట ఎవ్వరూ అబద్ధం కాదు.
25.12 She slaps him. Hard. His head turns. He turns it back slowly. Doesn't touch his cheek. CAMERA Two-shot in profile, 50mm, cheat angle for the stunt slap. CU Vikram turning his head back, 85mm.	VIKRAM Your husband hit you for twenty years and you never hit back once. You told me. Look at you now. Who taught you that? నీ భర్త ఇరవై ఏళ్లు కొట్టాడు, నువ్వోమ ఒక్కసారి కూడా తిరిగి కొట్టలేదు. నువ్వో చాప్ పాము. ఇప్పుడు నీనో చూడు. ఇదో ఎవరు నేర్పారు?
25.13 She slaps him again. He lets her. CAMERA Same profile two-shot; second slap.	RANI Did you — did you feel anything? Any night? The birthday? The cake? నీకు — నీకోమైనా అనిపించిందా? ఏ రాత్రినా? పుట్టినరోజు? ఆ కేక్?

25.14 For the first time, he hesitates.

CAMERA Tight CU Vikram, 85mm; hold the hesitation.

VIKRAM

The cake was real.

ఆ కేక్ నిజం.

RANI

The cake was a lever.

ఆ కేక్ కూడా ఒక లీవర్.

VIKRAM

The cake was real.

ఆ కేక్ నిజం.

25.15 She stares at him. She cannot tell. Neither can we. She runs to the bedroom, pulls out her steel trunk, throws sarees into it, the jeans, the red top — no, she throws the red top across the room. Kiran and Sravya's photo from the shelf. She drags the trunk to the door. He doesn't stop her. He leans on the counter and watches.

CAMERA Handheld, 35mm, chaotic packing. Insert: red top thrown across the room. Wide from the counter, 24mm: Vikram foreground still, Rani dragging the trunk to the door.

VIKRAM

Where will you go?

ఎక్కడకి వెళ్తావు?

25.16 She has her hand on the door handle.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hand on the door handle. MS Vikram at the counter, 50mm, for the speech (one take, no push).

VIKRAM

It's eleven forty at night. Raining. You have eleven hundred rupees in your purse — I know because I know. The last bus to your village left at nine. Your bank account has the spa salary, which is Leela's account, which she can freeze tomorrow. Sravya's fee is due on the fifteenth. You'll call Ammamma and say what? "The good boy who got me a job sold me"? She'll have a heart attack. You'll tell Sravya? She'll leave college to work in a mall. Kiran will drop out. That's what you'll go to.

రాత్రి పదికొండు నలభై. వర్షం పడుతోంది. నీ పర్సులో పదికొండు వందలు ఉన్నాయి — నాకు తెలుసు, ఎందుకంటే నాకు తెలుసుతుంది. మీ ఊరికి లాస్ట్ బస్ ను తొమ్మిదింటికే వాళ్ళ లిఫ్ట్ చేసింది. నీ బ్యాంక్ అకౌంట్ లో ఉన్నది స్పా జీతం, అది లీల అకౌంట్, రేపే ఫ్రీజ్ చేయగలదు. శ్రీరమ్మ ఫీజు పదిహేనో తారీఖు. అమ్మమ్మకి ఫోన్ చేసి ఏం చెప్తావు? "ఉద్యోగం ఇవ్వించిన ఆ మంచి పోల్ లోడు నన్ను అమ్మేశాడు" అనా? ఆవిడకి గుండెపోటు వస్తోంది. శ్రీరమ్మకి చెప్తావా? కాలేజీ మానసి మార్ లో పనికి వాళ్ళు ఉన్నారు. కిరణ్ చదువు ఆపేస్తాడు. నువ్వు వాళ్ళలోదా అక్కడికి.

25.17 Her hand stays on the handle. It is shaking. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: the shaking hand on the handle.	VIKRAM Or you stay. One booking. Saturday. Forty thousand. I'm not lying about the money. That's Sravya's fee in one night. One night, and she becomes the first woman in your family to finish a degree. You'll be the reason. లేదా ఇక్కడే ఉండు. ఒక్క బుకింగ్. శనివారం. నలభై వేలు. డబ్బు వాషింగ్టన్ అబద్ధం చాఫ్ పట్లేదు. ఒక్క రోతర్ లో శ్రావ్య ఘోష. ఒక్క రోతర్, మీ కుటుంబంలో డిగ్రీ పూర్తి చేసిన మొదటి ఆడపిల్ల అవుతుంది. దానికి కారణం నువ్వే. RANI You'll make me the reason for this? దీనికి నన్ను కారణం చేస్తావా? VIKRAM I'm making you the reason for her. తనకి కారణం చేస్తున్నా.
25.18 She turns the handle. Opens the door. The corridor outside is dark; the rain is loud from the stairwell. She stands on the threshold — half in, half out — for a very long time. Hold it. Thirty seconds. Forty-five. CAMERA From the dark corridor looking in, 35mm: Rani framed in the doorway, half lit by the flat, half dark. Locked off; hold 45 seconds, rain sound up.	—
25.19 She shuts the door. Leans her forehead against it. Slides down to the floor, crying without any sound at all. CAMERA Inside, 50mm: she slides down the door into a low frame; no sound but room tone.	—

25.20 Vikram comes and sits on the floor beside her. He doesn't touch her. Then he does: his hand on her back, exactly where she showed him the kick landed. She flinches. Then she leans into him. She hates herself for it. She leans anyway. CAMERA Floor-level two-shot, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: his hand landing on the exact spot on her lower back (match to the Scene 8 insert).	RANI (<i>whispering</i>) I hate you. నానాను దావాషిస్ తునానా. VIKRAM I know. తాలను. RANI I hate you. నానాను దావాషిస్ తునానా. VIKRAM I know. Hate me tomorrow. Tonight, sleep. తాలను. రోమ దావాషించు. ఈ రాత్ రోకొ పడుకో.
25.21 He lifts her. She lets him carry her to the bed. That is the horror of the scene: she lets him. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, from the terrace door: he carries her across the hall into the bedroom; hold on the empty doorway after.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The most important dialogue scene in the film: block on day 1, shoot on day 2 with two cameras. Ledger pages designed by art department in Vikram's handwriting, inks visibly different week to week; on-screen text must be legible in inserts. Slaps are choreographed by the stunt coordinator (camera-side cheat, sound added in post). Towel safety: Vikram changes into V9 navy T-shirt off camera after the first exchange if the director prefers. The 30–45 second hold at the open door must play in full — no cutaway. From this scene on, Telugu dialogue drops from మీరు to నువ్వోమ.

SCENE 26 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / BATHROOM / HALL — SATURDAY NIGHT

Scene No.	26	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — wardrobe mirror, empty hall, bathroom door; terrace at dawn	Story day, date & time	Day 69 · Sat 16 August · 19:30 → 02:50 → dawn 05:50
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R15: black sheer georgette saree, gold-tone necklace, heels, evening purse; after return R14 towel wrap (modest framing) VIKRAM — Costume V11: dark bomber jacket over black shirt, car keys		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Wardrobe mirror, necklace, small purse containing: a phone with one saved number, lipstick, condoms (packaging only, de-branded), pepper spray; her half-finished cup of tea on the counter, toothbrush, framed photo of the children, wall clock (practical, hands set per time-cut), fridge, a lizard (VFX or trained), envelope thick with prop cash, dry towel, terrace at dawn		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
26.1 EVENING. The bedroom. Rani at the wardrobe mirror in a black saree he has bought — sheer, expensive. He stands behind her, fastening a necklace, like a husband before a wedding. Her face in the mirror is completely blank. CAMERA Mirror shot, 50mm: both faces in the wardrobe mirror, his hands at her neck. Her face dead centre, blank.	VIKRAM You look — నువ్వేమి — RANI Don't. వద్దేదు.

26.2 He stops. He hands her a small purse. Inside: a phone with one number saved, a lipstick, condoms, a pepper spray.

CAMERA Top-down insert, 100mm: purse opened, contents shown.

VIKRAM

Room 412. If anything — anything — you press this and I'm in the lobby in four minutes. I'll be there all night. In the car.

రూమ్ నాలుగు వందల పన్ నాండు. ఏదైనా — ఏదైనా సరే — ఇదో నొక్కకు, నాలుగు నోమోషల్ లో లాబీలో ఉంటా. రొత్త రంతా అక్కడే ఉంటా. కార్ లో.

RANI

In the car. Waiting. Like a driver.

కార్ లో. ఎదురుచూసే తూ. డ్రైవర్ లా.

VIKRAM

Like a bodyguard.

బాడీగార్ డ్ లా.

RANI

Like a shopkeeper waiting for the cash.

డబ్బు కోసం ఎదురుచూసే దుకాణదారుడిలా.

26.3 She walks out of the frame. The door closes. We do NOT follow her. The camera stays in the empty flat. Real time slows to a crawl. Her cup of tea, half finished, on the counter. Her toothbrush. The photo of her children. The clock: nine. Ten. Eleven. Midnight. One. The fridge hums. A lizard crosses the wall. Two. This passage should be almost unbearable.

CAMERA Locked-off still-life plates, 35–50mm, each held 6–10 seconds: tea cup, toothbrush, photo, wall clock at each hour, lizard on the wall. No camera movement at all.

—

26.4 2:50 A.M. A key in the lock. Rani comes in alone. Her saree is wrinkled; the pallu is held over one shoulder with her fist. Her lipstick is gone. There is a red mark on her wrist. She walks past the couch, past the kitchen, straight into the bathroom without turning on a light. Locks the door.

CAMERA Wide master from the hall, 24mm, same frame as the still-lives; she crosses it in one move. Insert, 100mm: red mark on her wrist as she passes.

—

26.5 The shower turns on. Full force. Vikram enters a minute later — he followed her up from the car. He stands at the bathroom door.

CAMERA MS Vikram at the bathroom door, 50mm, door in frame.

VIKRAM

Rani.

రాణీ.

26.6 Nothing. The water. CAMERA Hold.	VIKRAM Rani, open. రాణీ, తలుపు తీయి.
26.7 Nothing. CAMERA Hold.	VIKRAM Did he hurt you? వాడు నీనను బాధపాటాడా?
26.8 From inside, a sound that is not quite crying — a deep, animal sound, muffled by a towel. CAMERA Sound only; CU Vikram's face against the door, 85mm.	—
26.9 He slides down the bathroom door and sits on the floor outside it. The water runs. Twenty minutes in real screen time compressed to four. Finally the lock clicks. She comes out in a towel, skin scrubbed red, hair dripping. She sees him on the floor. CAMERA Low angle from the floor, 35mm, Vikram against the door; dissolves to show time passing. Door opens above him; Rani framed from the shoulders up.	RANI He wanted me to call him "husband". వాడొన "ఏమండీ" అని పిలిచాడనినాడు.
26.10 She says it flatly. Then she laughs — a terrible laugh. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, hair dripping.	RANI Twenty years with a husband, and the first stranger also wants a husband. He held my wrist like this. Like him. Exactly like him. The same grip. All men have the same hands, Vikram. Did you know that? Same hands. ఇరవై ఏళ్లు ఒక భర్తతో, మొదటి పరాయివాడికి కూడా భర్త కావాలట. నా మణికట్టు ఇలా పట్టుకున్నాడు. అతనిలా. అచ్చం అతనిలా. అదే పట్టు. మగళ్లందరికీ ఒకే చేతులు వోకరమ్. నీకు తెలుసా? ఒకే చేతులు.
26.11 She holds out the envelope. Thick with cash. Drops it on the floor between them. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: envelope dropping to the floor between their feet.	RANI Count it. You're the accountant. లెక్కపాటటు. అకౌంటెంట్ వో నువ్వే కదా.

26.12 He doesn't touch it. He stands, takes a dry towel, and starts drying her hair, very gently, the way she once wiped his face. She stands rigid.

CAMERA Two-shot, 50mm, eye level; his hands in her hair, her body rigid.

VIKRAM

That one was bad. That's my fault. Leela didn't screen him. I'll never send you to him again. Next time I'll choose. Myself. Gentlemen only. Educated. Married men who just want to talk. Some of them just want to talk, Rani. I swear.

మాడు చౌడోడనాడు. తప్పో నాదే. లీల మాడొనో సర్గోగో చౌక్ చేయలేదు. ఇంకొప్పొడూ మాడో దగ్గోగోకో పంపను. ఈసారి నేననే సొలొక్కటో చేస్తా. నేననే. జంటోలొ మొనో మాత్రోరమే. చదుమకునోనవాళ్ళొ. కేవలం మాటోలాడాలనుకునే పొళ్ళొలయిన మగొళ్ళొ. క్కొందరు కేవలం మాటోలాడాలనే అనుకుంటారు రొణో. ఒటోటు.

RANI

Next time.

ఈసారి.

VIKRAM

I promise. Good customers next time.

ప్రోమీస్. ఈసారి మంచి కస్టమర్లొ.

26.13 She turns around and looks at him. Her face crumples. She collapses into his chest, sobbing, beating her fist weakly on his shoulder with every word.

CAMERA Tight two-shot, 85mm; her fist on his shoulder in frame.

RANI

Why — do — I — still — come — to — you?

ఇంకా — నీ — దగ్గోగోకో — ఎందుకు — వస్తొతున్నా?

VIKRAM

Because I'm the one who's here.

ఎందుకంటే ఇక్కడ ఉన్నదో నేనొక్కడొననే.

26.14 He holds her as she cries. The cash envelope sits on the floor between their feet, untouched. Fade.

CAMERA Tilt down from the embrace to the envelope on the floor, 35mm; fade.

—

26.15 DAWN, SAME NIGHT. She is asleep — or pretending. He sits on the terrace, counts the cash under the grey light. Divides it into two piles. Puts the larger pile in his pocket. Then — after a long hesitation — takes two notes from his pile and adds them to hers. We don't know if that is love or accounting.

CAMERA Terrace at blue dawn, 50mm; insert, 100mm: counting hands, two piles, two notes moved across. End on CU Vikram, 85mm, unreadable.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The empty-flat passage (9 p.m. to 2:50 a.m.) is the key unbearable sequence: shoot locked-off plates of each object with the clock reset per shot; real time, no music. The customer is never seen or heard. Red mark on her wrist by make-up (matches the grip in Scene 23). Towel wrap: modest framing, closed set, intimacy coordinator present. Prop cash marked "FOR FILM USE ONLY".

SCENE 27

INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — LATE MORNING

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	27 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, bed and chair beside it	Story day, date & time	Day 70 · Sun 17 August · 10:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R12: Vikram's oversized black T-shirt and cotton pyjamas VIKRAM — Costume V11: last night's black shirt, jacket off, red polish on fingertips		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Red nail polish bottle on the bedside table, chair beside the bed, sheet, sunlight through the window		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
27.1 Painted Toes. Rani wakes late into sunlight. She feels something cool on her feet and looks down. Her toenails have been painted red, carefully, every one of them neat. The bottle stands on the bedside table. Vikram is asleep in the chair beside the bed, still in last night's clothes, red polish on his fingertips. CAMERA CU Rani waking, 85mm. Her POV down the bed to her feet, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: neatly painted toes; insert: polish bottle; wide to include Vikram asleep in the chair, 35mm.	—

27.2 She stares at her feet. Then at him. Her eyes fill. He wakes.

CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm.

VIKRAM

I didn't go wrong this time. Not even one.

ఈసారి ఒక్కటూ కూడా తప్పు చేయలేదు. ఒక్కటూ కూడా.

RANI

Why?

ఎందుకు?

VIKRAM

You used to do it every Sunday. You stopped. Two weeks now. I noticed.

పొరత ఆదివారం చేసుకునేదానివి. ఆపేశావ్. రెండు వారాలైందో. నేను గమనించా.

RANI

You notice everything. That's your job.

నువ్వు అన్నీ గమనిస్తావ్. అదే నీ ఉద్యోగం.

VIKRAM

This one wasn't the job.

ఇదో ఉద్యోగం కాదు.

27.3 She looks at him for a long time. She wants to believe it. She draws her knees up and touches one red toenail with her fingertip, as if it were precious.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: fingertip touching one red toenail.

RANI

When I was small, Ammamma said a woman's feet should never touch dirt, because Lakshmi lives in them. After marriage I walked barefoot on a cow-dung floor for twenty years. Last night I walked into that hotel in heels you bought. And this morning a man painted my feet like they are worth something. I don't know which of these is the lie.

చొన్ నవ్ పుడు అమ్మమ్మ చాప్ పేదో, ఆడదానో పాదాలు

మట్టోనో తాకకూడదు, మాటోలో లక్ష్మీమి ఉంటుందనో.

పాళ్లలయ్ యాక ఇరవై ఏళ్లు పేడ అలికిన నోల మీద

చాప్ మల్ లేకుండా నడిచా. నొన్ న రాత్రో నువ్వు కొన్న

హీల్స్ తో ఆ హోటల్ లోకి నడిచా. ఈ పొద్దున ఒక మగ్గాడు నా

పాదాలకి వీలువ ఉన్ నట్టు రంగు వేశాడు. వీటోలో ఏదో అబద్ధమో తొలియట్ లోదు.

VIKRAM *(quietly)*

Maybe none. Maybe all.

ఏదో కాకపోవచ్చు. అన్ నో కావచ్చు.

27.4 He sits on the edge of the bed. She doesn't pull away. He takes her foot in his hands and blows on the polish to dry it. She laughs once, wetly, despite herself: it is the burnt finger from Scene 7, in reverse. She lets her head fall back on the pillow and closes her eyes. Her hand finds his hair. Hold.

CAMERA Static two-shot, 85mm, matching Scene 7's framing: his face at her foot, her face on the pillow. Hold to the end.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Make-up: Rani's toenails painted neatly red (every nail), Vikram's fingertips smudged red. Warm, soft sunlight — the first gentle light after the dark scenes. Blowing on the polish mirrors Scene 7: match the framing (static 85mm).

SCENE 28 MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — WEEKS

Scene No.	28	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — fridge calendar, kitchen, terrace, front door, hall floor	Story day, date & time	Days 71–110 · 18 August – 26 September · various nights and afternoons
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R16: dark-phase montage set (shawl over printed nightie; muted synthetic sarees; black saree variation) VIKRAM — Costume V11: bomber jacket (booking nights); V9: navy T-shirt (home)		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Fridge calendar (Saturdays circled → Wednesdays and Saturdays → nearly every day), steel tiffin box on top shelf with prop cash, Rani's phone with bank app (transfer screens: SRAVYA (FEES), KIRAN (LAPTOP), AMMAMMA (KNEE SURGERY)), takeaway containers piling up, cleaning supplies, shawl, cigarettes (herbal), whisky bottle and water jug (watering down), box of sweets, glass (breakaway sugar glass) to shatter against the fridge, broom and dustpan, tissue, ledger on counter with a new name page		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
28.1 A long, grim mirror of the Scene 16 montage. Same angles, same rooms, different life. One song: a slow, aching female melody. CAMERA Re-use Scene 16 frame grabs as the blocking reference for every set-up.	—
28.2 The calendar on the fridge: Saturdays circled, then Wednesdays and Saturdays, then almost every day. Cash going into a steel tiffin box on the top shelf. Rani at the bank app on her phone: transfers to SRAVYA (FEES), KIRAN (LAPTOP), AMMAMMA (KNEE SURGERY). Each transfer, she closes her eyes. CAMERA Locked-off calendar insert, 50mm, dissolving through the weeks. Insert, 100mm: cash into the tiffin box. Screen inserts for each transfer; CU Rani closing her eyes, 85mm.	—
28.3 She stops cooking. Takeaway containers pile up. The flat slowly returns to the mess of the first day — and then she cleans it all in one furious night at four a.m., and the cycle starts again. CAMERA Same wide master as Scene 2 (24mm from the front door) as a time-lapse of mess building; then handheld 35mm for the furious 4 a.m. clean.	—

28.4 She smokes more. Alone on the terrace in the afternoons, wrapped in a shawl even in the heat. She drinks larger pegs; he notices and quietly waters the bottle down. She notices that too. CAMERA Same dawn-rail frame as Scene 16, now harsh afternoon, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: water poured into the bottle; CU Rani noticing, 85mm.	—
28.5 COMING HOME, VARIATIONS. A night she comes home laughing: CAMERA Front-door locked-off, 35mm, repeated for each variation (matching the Scene 21 time-cut frame).	RANI He only talked about his ex-wife for two hours and cried. రొండు గంటలు తన మాజీ భార్య గురించే మాట్లాడి ఏడ్చాడు అంతే.
28.6 A night she comes home with a bruise on her arm and says nothing. A night she comes home and immediately throws up in the sink. A night she comes home with a box of sweets a client gave her and stares at it like it's an insult. CAMERA Same front-door frame for each entry; inserts, 100mm: bruise; sink; box of sweets.	—
28.7 Each time, Vikram: drying her hair, pressing her feet, making her a virgin mojito, holding her while she cries, promising. His promises become a rhythm, like a prayer. CAMERA Repeated inserts, 50mm, of the same gestures from earlier scenes (towel in hair, feet, mojito pour). His voice overlaps across cuts.	VIKRAM Better ones next time. That's the last time with him. This month, only regulars. ఈసారి ఇంకా మంచివాళ్ళు. వాడొక్కో అదే లాస్ట్. ఈ నెల రెగ్యులర్స్ మాత్రమే.

28.8 FIGHTS. In the hall at three a.m.:

CAMERA Handheld two-shot, 35mm, harsh overhead tube light.

RANI

You took sixty percent of that night. Sixty! For sitting in a car!

ఆ రౌతర్ అరవై శాతం నువ్వే తీసుకున్నావ్. అరవై! కూర్చోని కూర్చున్నందుకు!

VIKRAM

For finding him, checking him, bribing the hotel, paying Leela, paying the police beat constable every month so you don't get picked up in a raid. You think safety is free?

వాడొని వాతొకినందుకు, చౌక్ చేసినందుకు, హోటల్ కి లంచం ఇచ్చినందుకు, లీలకి ఇచ్చినందుకు, రైడ్ లో నోన్ ను పట్టుకోకుండా బీట్ కానస్టేబుల్ కి నాలనాలా ఇచ్చినందుకు. సేఫ్ టీ ఫర్ గా వసతుందనుకున్నావా?

RANI

Safe? You call this safe?

సేఫ్? దీనిని సేఫ్ అంటావా?

VIKRAM

You're alive. You're paid. You're home by four. Ask the girls on the highway what safe means.

బతకి ఉన్నావ్. డబ్బు వసతుందో. నాలుగంటికల్లా ఇంట్లో ఉంటున్నావ్. హైవే మీద ఉండే అమ్మాయిల్ని అడుగు సేఫ్ అంటే ఏంటో.

28.9 She throws a glass. It shatters against the fridge. He sweeps it up silently. She watches him sweep, then gets down and helps, and they both cut their fingers on the same shard, and laugh — a mad, broken laugh — and bleed into the same tissue. And then they are in each other's arms again on the kitchen floor, and the cut comes before anything more.

CAMERA Sugar-glass shatter at 120fps, 35mm. Floor-level two-shot, 50mm; insert, 100mm: two bleeding fingertips on one tissue. Cut away as they embrace.

—

28.10 PHONE CALLS, intercut, voices only. CAMERA Rani on the terrace, MS 50mm, phone to ear.	AMMAMMA (V.O.) Rani, the doctor says the surgery went well. They're asking who paid. I told them my granddaughter works in a big spa in Hyderabad. They're all jealous. రాణీ, ఆపరేషన్ బాగా జరిగిందని డాక్టర్ టర్ చాప్ పాడు. డబ్బు ఎవరు కట్టారని అడుగుతున్నారు. నా మనవరాలు హైదరాబాద్ లో హార్డెడ్ సహాలో పని చేస్తోతుందని చాప్ పా. అందరికీ కుళ్లు. KIRAN (V.O.) Amma, the new laptop is so fast! Everyone in the hostel is asking. I told them my mother is a manager! అమ్మా, కొత్త లప్ టాప్ చాలా ఫాస్ట్! హాస్టల్ లో అందరూ అడుగుతున్నారు. మా అమ్మ మేనేజర్ అని చాప్ పా!
28.11 Rani on the terrace, phone to her ear, smiling for the voices, her face wet. Vikram behind the glass, watching her. In one shot, through the glass, we see him with his own phone: a new name in the ledger on the counter. Someone else's first entry. "Arrived. Very shy." CAMERA From the terrace looking in, 50mm: Rani foreground (smiling, wet face); through the glass, Vikram at the counter with the open ledger, background only — readable but never inserted.	—
28.12 She doesn't see it. Or she sees it and turns away. The film lets us wonder. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; her eyes flick toward the glass, or don't — let the actor choose per take; director to pick in the edit.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Mirror Scene 16 shot-for-shot (same angles and lenses) so the audience feels the reversal. Bruise and cut-finger make-up; sugar-glass breakaway for the thrown glass; the shared shard is a rubber prop with a blood-capsule effect. Bank-app screens are generic graphics. Phone V.O.s (Ammamma, Kiran) recorded with phone filter. Final ledger insert ("Arrived. Very shy.") must be visible through the glass only in the background — do not cut to an insert.

SCENE 29

EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	29 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — jasmine pot and water tank	Story day, date & time	Day 112 · Sun 28 September · 21:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R17 : her late mother's red silk saree, jasmine garland, turmeric-yellow thread VIKRAM — Costume V12 : plain white cotton kurta and pyjama		
Screen duration (approx.)	~7 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Jasmine plant in full white bloom (hero pot from Scene 5; greens dept), sewing thread and needle from Rani's trunk, two jasmine garlands (made on camera + pre-made doubles), yellow puja thread rubbed with turmeric, turmeric powder, fairy lights strung over the water tank as a canopy, cooler box (phones dropped in, lid shut), Vikram's two phones		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
29.1 The Fairy-Light Wedding. A rare night with no booking. Rani stands at the jasmine from Scene 5. It has finally flowered; white buds cover it. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: jasmine flowers in full bloom (match the bud insert from Scene 16). MS Rani at the pot, 50mm.	RANI It flowered. Fifteen days, I said. It took months. మాసాందో. పదహారు రోజులన్నా. నాలుగు పట్టాందో. VIKRAM Late is not never. ఆలస్యం అంటే ఎప్పటికీ రాదని కాదు.

29.2 She plucks the flowers one by one into her palm. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: flowers gathering in her palm.	RANI Vikram. Give me one night. వీక్ రమ్. నాకు ఒక్క రాత్రి ఇవ్వమ. VIKRAM For what? దేనికొ? RANI One night where we're normal. No phone. No Leela. No ledger. You're just a man and I'm just a woman and we're — married. Just pretend. One night. మనం మామూలు మనుషులలా ఉండే ఒక్క రాత్రి. ఫోన్ వద్దు. లీల వద్దు. లాడర్జర్ వద్దు. నువ్వమ ఒక మగ్గాడివి, నేను ఒక ఆడదానననీ, మనకొ — పొళ్ళలయిందొ. నటించు చాలు. ఒక్క రాత్రి.
29.3 He looks at her. He takes out both phones, switches them off, drops them into the cooler box, and shuts the lid. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: both phones switched off and dropped into the cooler box; lid shut.	VIKRAM Done. అయిపోయిందొ.
29.4 MONTAGE over a soft song. He untangles the fairy lights and strings them over the water tank like a wedding canopy. She goes inside and returns in her mother's old red silk saree, the one wedding thing she brought from the village. She threads two garlands from the jasmine with sewing thread from her trunk. He finds a yellow puja thread in an event kit and rubs it with turmeric from the kitchen. CAMERA Montage coverage, 35mm handheld and 100mm inserts: lights strung; her reveal in the red silk saree (slow dolly, 50mm); needle threading jasmine; turmeric rubbed into the thread.	—
29.5 They stand facing each other under the lights. No priest, no guests. Only the city. CAMERA Symmetrical wide two-shot under the canopy, 24mm, skyline behind.	VIKRAM I don't know the mantras. నాకు మంత్రాలు రావు. RANI Nobody listens to the mantras. Say what you mean. మంత్రాలు ఎవరూ వినరు. మనసులో ఉన్నదొ చెప్పమ.

29.6 A long pause. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, searching for words.	VIKRAM I'll ask. Every time. Whether you're okay. Every single time. అడుగుతా. ప్లీజ్ అని అడగనున్నాను. ప్లీజ్ అని అడగనున్నాను.
29.7 That undoes her. Tears run down her face. She puts her garland on him; he puts his on her. He ties the yellow thread around her neck — three knots, fumbling. She laughs through her tears at his clumsiness and finishes the third knot herself. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, tears. Two-shot, 50mm, garlands exchanged. Insert, 100mm: fumbling knots; her fingers finishing the third.	RANI Seven steps. ఏడు అడుగులు.
29.8 They walk around the water tank, her pallu knotted to the hem of his kurta, counting aloud in Telugu: one, two, three, four, five, six, seven. At seven, she stops. CAMERA Steadicam circling with them around the water tank, 24mm, fairy lights streaking. Insert, 100mm: pallu knotted to his hem.	RANI & VIKRAM <i>(counting together)</i> One, two, three, four, five, six, seven. ఒకటి, రెండు, మూడు, నాలుగు, ఐదు, ఆరు, ఏడు. RANI The first time, I was thirteen. I didn't know what the steps meant. I was counting so I wouldn't cry. This time I'm counting so I remember. మొదటిసారి నాకు పదమూడేళ్లు. ఆ అడుగులకి అర్థం ఏంటో తెలియదు. ఏడవకుండా ఉండటానికి లెక్కపాటటా. ఈసారి గుర్తుంచుకోవడానికి లెక్కపాడుతున్నా.
29.9 They sit on the terrace floor, garlanded, under the lights. She rests her head on his shoulder. CAMERA Low wide two-shot from the floor, 35mm, fairy-light canopy above.	RANI Tomorrow you'll switch the phones on. రేపు ఫోన్లు ఆన్ చేస్తావా. VIKRAM Tomorrow. రేపు. RANI Tonight I'm a wife who was asked. ఈ రాత్రినా, అడిగి చేసుకున్న భార్యని నేను.

29.10 He kisses her temple. Jasmine, fairy lights, the city. Hold for a long time. Through the glass door behind them, on the kitchen counter, the ledger sits exactly where he left it. Cut.

CAMERA Slow push-in past them toward the glass door, 50mm, until the ledger on the counter inside is sharp in the background. Cut.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The visual peak of the romance: fairy-light canopy over the water tank, jasmine flowers real and fresh (replace every 2 hours). Mangalsutra-style knots are symbolic only — no priest, no fire, no religious idols; consult a cultural adviser for respectful staging. Seven steps around the water tank must be clear of cables. The ledger visible through the glass in the final frame is a background element only.

SCENE 30 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT, RAIN

Scene No.	30	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — front door, hall floor, couch	Story day, date & time	Day 118 · Sat 4 October · 23:50 → 03:00 (storm, power cut)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R18: printed chiffon saree with dupatta over her head, soaked through VIKRAM — Costume V2: grey vest, black track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~15 min	Movement	5 — The Dilemma
Props & furniture	Vikram's laptop (screen is the only light), couch, front door, rain in the doorway (water rig), towels off camera, no candles (deliberate contrast with Scene 8)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
30.1 Rain again. The same storm as Scene 8 — deliberately echoed: thunder, then the power cut. But this time there are no candles. Vikram is on the couch with his laptop, the screen the only light. Rani comes in soaked, a dupatta over her head, no umbrella. She stands dripping in the doorway. CAMERA Same locked-off wide as Scene 8, 24mm; laptop glow on Vikram's face. Rani silhouetted in the doorway by lightning.	—
30.2 She isn't hurt this time. Not visibly. She is something worse: calm. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, water running off her face, expression still.	RANI He was nineteen. నాడొక పంతామ్ మోదేశ్ లు.

30.3 Vikram looks up.

CAMERA CU Vikram, laptop-lit, 85mm.

RANI

Tonight's client. Nineteen. His friends paid for him. A birthday gift. He was shaking more than me. He kept calling me "aunty". He said "Sorry, aunty". "Is this okay, aunty." Kiran is nineteen.

ఈ రోజు క్లయింట్. పంతామ్ మిదేశ్ లు. వాడి ఫ్రెండ్స్ డబ్బు కట్టారు. బర్త్ డే గిఫ్ట్ అంట. నా కంటే వాడే ఎక్కువ వణికిపోతున్నాడు. "ఆంటీ" అని పిలుస్తూనే ఉన్నాడు. "సార్ ఆంటీ" అన్నాడు. "ఇదో ఓకేనా ఆంటీ" అన్నాడు. కరెన్ కి కూడా పంతామ్ మిదేశ్.

30.4 She sits down on the floor, right where she is, in her wet clothes.

CAMERA High angle, 35mm: Rani on the floor in a pool of rainwater.

RANI

I told him to go home. I sat with him for two hours and he told me about his exams and his mother. I gave him water. I told him to study. When he left, he touched my feet. He touched my feet, Vikram.

ఇంటికి వెళ్లిపో అని చెప్పా. రెండు గంటలు వాడితో కూర్చున్నా, వాడి ఎగ్జామిన్స్ గురించి, వెళ్లిపోమి గురించి చెప్పాడు. నీళ్లు ఇచ్చా. చదువుకో అని చెప్పా. వెళ్తూ నా కాళ్లకి దండం పట్టాడు. నా కాళ్లకి దండం పట్టాడు పోర్నమ్.

30.5 She starts to laugh, and it turns into crying halfway through, and then back to laughing, and she can't stop either.

CAMERA Hold CU Rani, 85mm, one take.

RANI

Leela will cut my share because he "didn't get his money's worth".

"వాడికి డబ్బుకు తగ్గ సర్వీస్ దక్కలేదు" అని లీల నా మాటా కట్ చేస్తోంది.

30.6 Vikram closes the laptop. Dark. Only lightning now.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: laptop closing; frame goes black; lightning flashes reveal both.

VIKRAM

I'll talk to Leela.

లీలతో నేను మాట్లాడతా.

RANI

No. Listen to me. For once, you listen and I talk. Like the first rain. You remember the first rain?

వదోదు. నా మాట వీను. ఒక్కసారైనా, నువ్వేమి వీను, నేను

మాట్లాడతా. మొదటి వర్షంలా. మొదటి వర్షం గుర్తుందా?

VIKRAM

I remember.

గుర్తుందో.

RANI

That night you said I left exactly on time. The day the children were safe.

ఆ రాత్రిలో నువ్వవ్వనావ్, నేను సరిగ్గా సమయానాకే

వదలిపోయానని. పోలీసులు సేఫ్ అయిన రోజు.

30.7 She gets up on her knees and crawls to the couch, sits at his feet, takes his hands. Pleading. The posture of a devotee.

CAMERA Low angle from floor level, 35mm: Rani at his feet, Vikram above on the couch.

RANI

I want to leave on time again. Please. Please, Vikram. You know everyone in this city. You arranged a spa in one phone call. Arrange a decent job.

Anything. Cook in a hotel kitchen. Housekeeping. Receptionist. I'll learn computer. I'll sweep floors. I'll take twelve thousand. Ten. Just let me come home and look at my children's photo without turning it face down.

మళ్ళీ సమయానాకే వదలిపోయాలనుందో. ప్లీజ్. ప్లీజ్ వీక్రమ్.

ఈ ఊర్లో నీకు అందరూ తెలుసు. ఒక్క ఫోన్ తో సోపా ఏర్పాటు

చేశావ్. ఒక మంచి ఉద్యోగం ఏర్పాటు చేయి. ఏదైనా సరే.

హోటల్ కోచాన్ లో వంట. హౌస్ కీపింగ్. రిసెప్షనిస్ట్.

కంప్యూటర్ నేర్చుకుంటా. నేలలు ఊడుస్తా. పన్నెండు వేలు

చాలు. పది వేలు. ఇంటికొచ్చి నా పోలీసు ఫోటోని బోర్లా

తవ్వకుండా చూసుకోనీవ్మ చాలు.

30.8 He looks at their joined hands. For a long moment, we think he might.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: joined hands, lightning-lit. CU Vikram, 85mm; hold.

VIKRAM

Ten thousand.

పదో వేలలు.

RANI

I'll manage.

సర్దుకుంటా.

VIKRAM

Sravya's last semester is sixty-two. Her placement suits and travel, fifteen.

Kiran has two more years: two lakh eighty, minimum, if he doesn't fail

anything. Ammamma's follow-up physiotherapy, eight thousand a month.

Your room rent if you leave here — Gachibowli, cheapest, nine thousand.

Food. Bus. Phone. You want to do this on ten?

శ్రీరావుయ లాస్ట్ సెమిస్టర్ అరవై రౌండు వేలు.

వోల్టేజ్ మౌంట్ బట్టలు, వర్కయూనింగ్, పదిహేను. కీరణ్ కి ఇంకా

రౌండ్ వేలు: కనీసం రౌండు లక్షల ఎనభై, ఒక్క సబ్ జాక్ట్ కూడా

ఫోయిల్ అవ్వకపోతే. అమ్మమ్మ ఫిజియోథెరపీ, నాలకి

ఎనిమిది వేలు. ఇక్కడ నుంచి వాళ్ళతో రూమ్ రౌంట్ —

గచ్చిబౌలిలో అతే తక్కువ, తొమ్మిది వేలు. తొండో. బస్సు.

ఫోన్. ఇదంతా పది వేలతోనా?

RANI

People do it!

జనం చేస్తోతున్నారుగా!

VIKRAM

People's children drop out! Their grandmothers stop physio! You told me

Kiran wants to do an MS in America. On ten thousand? Who's paying, his

father?

జనం పిల్లలు చదువు మానోస్తోతున్నారు! వాళ్ళ అమ్మమ్మలు

ఫిజియో ఆపోస్తోతున్నారు! కీరణ్ అమెరికాలో ఎంఎస్

చేయాలనుకుంటున్నాడని నువ్వే చెప్పావ్. పది వేలతోనా?

ఎవరు కడతారు, వాడో నానోనా?

30.9 That lands like a slap. She lets go of his hands.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hands letting go.

VIKRAM

I'm not saying it to hurt you. I'm saying it because nobody else will say it to you straight. This city pays a woman with ninth class ten thousand rupees for twelve hours of standing. It pays you forty for one night. That's not my rule. I just know the rule.

నానాను బాధపాటోటడానాకో చావోపటోలేదు. ఇంకావోవరూ నీకు సూటోగా చావోవరు కాబటోటో చావోతున్నా. తొమ్మోమోదో తరగతో చదోవోన ఆడదానాకో ఈ ఊరు పన్నాండు గంటలు నలబడోతో పదో వోలు ఇన్నోతుందో. నీకు ఒక్క రోతోరోకో నలభై ఇన్నోతుందో. అదో నా రూల్ కాదు. ఆ రూల్ నాకు తోలుసు అంతో.

RANI

You made me into the rule!

నన్నో ఆ రూల్ గా మార్చావో!

VIKRAM

I showed you the rule!

నీకు ఆ రూల్ చూపించా అంతో!

30.10 They are both on their feet now. Thunder. Lightning shows their faces in flashes.

CAMERA Handheld two-shot, 35mm, standing face to face; lightning strobes in rhythm with the lines.

RANI

You knew from the first day! From the bus station! You looked at my trunk and said "you brought the whole house" and you were already counting! Every pillow that came off that bed was a step in your book!

మొదటో రోజు నుంచో నీకు తోలుసు! బస్ స్టాప్ నుంచో! నా టోరంకో పాటోటా చూసో "ఇల్లు మొత్తం తాచోచోశారా"

అన్నావో, అప్పుడో లాక్కలు మొదలుపాటోటావో! ఆ బెడ్ మోద నుంచో పోయోన పోరతో దొండా నో పున్నోతకంలొ ఒక స్టాప్!

VIKRAM

And did you hate those steps? Tell me. Tell me the truth. The terrace. The jeans. The cake. The nights. Did you hate any of it?

ఆ స్టాప్ నో నీకు నచ్చలేదా? చావోమ. నోజం చావోమ.

టోరస్. జీన్స్. కేక్. ఆ రోతరుళ్లు. వాటోలొ ఏదైనా నీకు అసహ్యంగా అనోపించోందా?

30.11 She can't answer. That is the knife.

CAMERA Locked-off CU Rani, 85mm; 5 seconds of silence and rain.

VIKRAM

I gave you thirty-five years in two months. Nobody else ever gave you even one day. Your father gave you to a man. Your husband gave you to his mother. Your mother-in-law gave you to the kitchen. I'm the only one who ever gave you to yourself.

రొండు నాలిల్లో నీకు మువ్వపై ఐదేళ్లు ఇచ్చా. ఇంకావ్వరూ నీకు ఒక్క రోజు కూడా ఇవ్వలేదు. మనీ నానన నానను ఒక మగ్గాడికి ఇచ్చాడు. నీ భర్త నానను వాళ్ల అమ్మకి ఇచ్చాడు. మనీ అత్త నానను వంటింటికి ఇచ్చిందీ. నానను నీకే ఇచ్చిందీ నీనొక్కడే.

RANI

And then you sold me.

ఆ తర్వాత నానను అమ్మమ్మేశా.

30.12 Silence. Long. The rain.

CAMERA Wide two-shot, 24mm; hold 6 seconds.

VIKRAM *(quietly)*

And then I sold you.

ఆ తర్వాత నానను అమ్మమ్మేశా.

30.13 He sits down, suddenly tired. For the first time in the film he looks his age — twenty-five, young, and lost in his own trade.

CAMERA MS Vikram on the couch, 50mm, slight high angle, making him small.

VIKRAM

You think I wanted to be this? My mother sweeps your Ammamma's courtyard for three hundred a week. I came to this city with eight hundred rupees, that part was true. The first event I "managed" was carrying chairs. The second was carrying a drunk girl to a car for a man who gave me five thousand. That's how it starts. Nobody plans it. You just find out what you're worth to people, and it's always more than the honest price.

నేను ఇలా అవ్వాలనుకున్నానా? మా అమ్మమ్మ వారానాకి మూడొందలకి మీ అమ్మమ్మమ్మ వాకాలి ఊడుస్ తుంది. ఎన్నోమీదీ వందలతో ఈ ఊరికి వచ్చా, అదీ నోజమే. నేను "మేనేజ్" చేసిన మొదటి ఈవెంట్ కుర్చీలు మోయడం. రౌండ్లోదీ, ఐదు వోలు ఇచ్చిన ఒకడి కోసం తాగో ఉన్న ఒక అమ్మమ్మాయినో కూర్చు దాకా మోయడం. అలాగే మొదలమతుంది. ఎవరూ ప్లాన్ చేయరు. జనానాకి నువ్వమ్మ ఎంత వోలువో తాలుస్ తుంది, అదీ ఎఫ్మడూ నోజాయితో ధర కంటే ఎక్కువే ఉంటుంది.

RANI

Then stop.

అయితే ఆపేయ్.

VIKRAM

Then what? I go back to chairs? You go back to ten thousand? And we live here in love like a film song while Sravya sells her chain to pay fees?

తర్వాత? నేను మళ్ళీ కుర్చీలు మోయాలా? నువ్వమ్మ పదో వోలకి వాళ్ళలా? ఫీజు కోసం శ్రీరావ్ గౌలును అమ్మముకుంటుంటే మనం ఇక్కడ సోనామా హుటలా ప్లోరేమించుకుంటూ బతకాలా?

30.14 She has no answer. Neither does he. They sit — she on the floor, he on the couch — a metre apart, the same distance as the first night of the rain. The lights do not come back on this time.

CAMERA Wide, 24mm, matching Scene 8's couch frame exactly; lightning only.

RANI (*whispering*)

I can't leave you.

నీనాను వదలలే వాళ్ళలాంటిను.

VIKRAM

I know.

తెలుసు.

RANI

That's the worst part. Not the men. Not the money. That I can't leave you. When I come home from them, I come home to you, and you dry my hair, and I'm grateful. I'm grateful to the man who sent me. What kind of woman is that?

అదే అనానాటికంటే ఘోరం. ఆ మగాళ్ళలా కూడు. డబ్బు కూడు.

నీనాను వదలలేకపోవడం. వాళ్ళలా దగ్గరనుంచో ఇంటికొస్తా, నీ దగ్గరకి వస్తా, నువ్వు నా జుట్టు తుడుస్తావా, నాకు కృతజ్ఞత కలుగుతుంది. నీనాను పంపినవాడే మీదే కృతజ్ఞత. అలాంటి ఆడదే ఎలాంటిది?

VIKRAM

A tired one.

అలసిపోయినది.

RANI

An addicted one. You're my cigarette. I know it's killing me and my hand still reaches.

అలవాటైపోయినది. నువ్వు నా సిగరెట్ వా. చంపుతోందని తెలుసు, అయినా చేయి దాని వైపు వాళ్ళలాంటిది.

30.15 He slides down from the couch to the floor beside her. Not touching. Their shoulders almost touching. The same picture as Scene 8, mirrored. CAMERA Floor-level two-shot, 50mm, mirrored composition of Scene 8 (flip sides).	VIKRAM Do you want me to promise? పాపంమీనా చామంటావా? RANI Promise what? ఏమనో? VIKRAM Anything. Good customers. A real job. Marriage. Whatever you want to hear tonight. ఏదైనా. మంచి కస్టమర్లు. నిజమైన ఉద్యోగం. పెళ్ళి. ఈ రోజున నువ్వేం వానాలనుకుంటే అదో. RANI Would it be true? అదో నిజమవుతుందా?
30.16 A very long beat. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; hold 8 seconds.	VIKRAM I don't know anymore. ఇప్పుడు నాకే తెలియటలేదు.
30.17 That is the most honest thing he has said in the film. She puts her head on his shoulder. He puts his arm around her. They sit in the dark, in the storm, holding each other, neither of them asleep. CAMERA Slow pull-back to a wide, 24mm; lightning flashes reveal them, then darkness.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Exact echo of Scene 8: same storm design, same lightning cues, same couch position — but no candles; the laptop is the only light until it closes, then lightning only. Rani stays wet for the whole scene: warm-water rig, wardrobe doubles of R18, heater and robe between takes. Long takes for the fight; two cameras. The power does not come back on.

SCENE 31 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — BEFORE DAWN NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	31 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — stove and counter	Story day, date & time	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 04:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree (she has changed into her arrival saree) VIKRAM — Costume V13: grey vest and track pants, crumpled from a night on the floor		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	5 — The Dilemma
Props & furniture	Kadai with tadka (mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic), steel plate of upma, steel tumbler and dabara of filter coffee, spoons, counter stool		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
31.1 The Last Upma. 4:30 a.m. The storm has passed; the power is back. Rani stands at the stove. Mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic: the same tadka as Scene 4. Vikram wakes on the floor where they sat all night, smells it, and comes to the counter. She sets a steel plate of upma and a tumbler of filter coffee in front of him, exactly as on the first morning. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: mustard seeds popping (match Scene 4). MCU Vikram waking on the floor, 50mm. Same counter two-shot as Scene 4, 35mm.	VIKRAM Upma. ఉప్పమా. RANI The first morning. You closed your eyes on the first spoon. I saw. మొదటి పొద్దున. మొదటి ముద్దకే కళ్ళలు మూసుకున్నావ్. నేను చూశా.
31.2 They eat in silence, standing at the counter, shoulders touching. Long, real-time: only spoons on steel and the city waking. CAMERA Profile two-shot at the counter, 50mm, locked off; 60–90 seconds of real time.	VIKRAM Why now? ఇప్పుడందుకు? RANI Because I wanted to cook for you once more without counting anything. ఏ లొక్కలా లోకుండా నీకు ఇంకోసారి వండో పోటోటాలనిపించిందో.
31.3 He puts the spoon down. He understands something and doesn't say it. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: spoon set down on the plate (echo of Scene 4). CU Vikram, 85mm.	—

31.4 She hums the Ghantasala tune softly. He takes her hand and draws her away from the stove. They dance in the narrow kitchen with no music but her humming, slow, barely moving, her head under his chin. CAMERA Slow arc around the two of them, 35mm on slider; humming only.	VIKRAM <i>(whispering)</i> Stay. ఉండొచ్చో.
31.5 She doesn't answer. She keeps humming. CAMERA CU Rani, eyes closed against his chest, 85mm.	VIKRAM Stay. I'll — I'll figure something out. ఉండొచ్చో. నోను — ఏదొక్కటో చేస్తా.
31.6 She stops humming and looks up at him. CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm.	RANI Ask me. అడుగు. VIKRAM What? ఏంటి? RANI You promised. On the terrace. Every time. Ask me. ప్రోమిస్ చేశావ్. టెర్రస్ మీద. ప్రతిసారీ అనో. అడుగు.
31.7 A long beat. His eyes fill. It is the first time we have seen him cry. CAMERA ECU Vikram's eyes, 100mm.	VIKRAM Are you okay, Rani? నువ్వు బాగున్నావా రాణీ?
31.8 She looks at him for a long time. She touches his wet cheek with her thumb, the way she wiped the mud from his face in Scene 5. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her thumb on his wet cheek (match Scene 5's pallu wipe).	RANI Mango thief. మామడికాయల దొంగ.
31.9 She doesn't answer the question. She rests her head on his chest, and they keep dancing. Behind them, the window greys toward dawn. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, window behind them shifting from black to grey; hold.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Exact recreation of Scene 4's tadka and plate — same plate, tumbler and stool position; storm has passed, power back. Vikram's tears must be genuine or very well supported (no glycerine close-ups). Keep the dance slow, almost still; humming live, no score until the final hold.

SCENE 32 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN

Scene No.	32	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — rail, water tank, terrace door and stairwell door	Story day, date & time	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 06:00 (sunrise)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree (exact arrival look) VIKRAM — Costume V13: grey vest and track pants, crumpled		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	5 — The Dilemma
Props & furniture	Rani's steel trunk (packed), wet terrace (sprayed), dead fairy lights over the water tank with one broken bulb, jasmine pot with fallen flowers, Rani's phone (voice-note waveform graphic), Vikram's second phone (booking preview graphic), terrace door, stairwell door		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / తెలుగు
32.1 The storm has passed. The terrace is wet and glittering. The city below washed clean. The fairy lights from Club Penthouse and the wedding still hang over the water tank, dead, one bulb broken. The jasmine has dropped its flowers in the rain. CAMERA Wide establishing, 24mm, sunrise; insert, 100mm: broken bulb; insert: fallen jasmine flowers on wet floor.	—
32.2 Rani stands at the rail in the turmeric cotton saree from Scene 1. Her steel trunk is beside her — packed. We don't know when she packed it. Vikram comes out, sees the trunk, stops. CAMERA MS Rani at the rail, 50mm, trunk in frame (match the platform composition of Scene 1). Reverse MS Vikram in the doorway.	—
32.3 They look at each other. No words. CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm; hold.	—

32.4 Her phone buzzes. A voice note from Sravya. She plays it on speaker. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: voice-note waveform on screen. CU Rani listening, 85mm.	SRAVYA (<i>V.O., voice note</i>) Amma! Amma, I got it! Campus placement! A big audit firm, here in Hyderabad! Four point two lakhs a year! Joining in June! I'll be in your city, Amma! We can live together! You can quit, you can rest, I'll take care of everything now! I couldn't wait to tell you. Call me when you wake up. Love you, Amma. Love you, love you, love you! అమ్మమా! అమ్మమా, వచ్చాననిందా! క్లయింపస్ ప్లెస్ మంట్! హైదరాబాద్ లోనే ఒక పాదా ఆడిట్ కంపనీ! ఏడాదికొ నాలుగు లక్షల ఇరవై వేలు! జూన్ లో జాయిన్ అంగ్! నీ ఊర్లోనే ఉంటా అమ్మమా! మనం కలిసి ఉండొచ్చు! నువ్వు ఉద్యోగం మానేయొచ్చు, రిసర్ట్ తీసుకోవచ్చు, ఇక అన్నీ నేను చూసుకుంటా! నీకు చాఫ్ పకుండా ఆగలేకపోయా. లేవగొనే ఫోన్ చేయ్. లవ్ యూ అమ్మమా. లవ్ యూ, లవ్ యూ, లవ్ యూ!
32.5 The voice note ends. Rani's hand goes over her mouth. Tears stream down. She laughs — a pure, unbroken laugh, the one from the first morning. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; hold through the laugh (match the Scene 2 hand-to-mouth).	—
32.6 Then the arithmetic arrives on her face. June. Eight months away. Joining salary. Kiran's two years. Ammamma's physio. The rent. The math Vikram taught her. And her daughter coming to live in this city — the city where she is known in room 412. CAMERA Same CU, no cut; the expression changes within the shot.	—
32.7 She looks down at her open palm. The ink house from Scene 22 washed away weeks ago; only a faint blue smudge remains in one crease. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: open palm, faint blue smudge in a crease.	—
32.8 Vikram's second phone vibrates in his pocket. He takes it out. Looks at it. A booking. We see only the preview: "Tonight 9pm. Regular. Asked for R specifically. 50." CAMERA Insert, 100mm: booking preview on the second phone (screen graphic).	—

32.9 He looks up at Rani. She saw it. She looks at the phone. At him. At the trunk. At the city. At her own phone with her daughter's voice still on the screen. CAMERA Sequence of eye-line cuts, 85mm: her look to each object in turn.	VIKRAM <i>(barely audible)</i> I can say no to him. నాడికి నేను వద్దనో చాప్ పగలను. RANI Can you? చాప్ పగలనా?
32.10 He doesn't answer. She picks up the trunk handle. Holds it. The same grip as the platform in Scene 1. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her grip on the trunk handle (exact match of Scene 1's bag-handle insert).	—
32.11 She looks at the open terrace door: behind it, the bedroom, the bed, the man. She looks at the stairwell door: behind it, the city, the bus, the village, her children, a life of ten thousand rupees and a clean conscience. CAMERA Her POV: terrace door into the flat, 35mm; her POV: stairwell door, 35mm. Back to MS Rani between them.	—
32.12 Vikram's phone vibrates again in his hand. Unanswered. The camera slowly pushes in on Rani's face. She doesn't move. Her knuckles whiten on the trunk handle. The phone keeps vibrating. Her daughter's voice-note waveform glows on her screen. CAMERA One continuous dolly push-in from MS to ECU, 50mm → 85mm equivalent, about 60 seconds. Vibration sound continuous.	—
32.13 Hold. Hold. Hold. She opens her mouth to speak — CUT TO BLACK. CAMERA Hard cut to black on the first parting of her lips.	—
32.14 In the silence, one last sound: the steel trunk being set down — or lifted. We cannot tell which. CAMERA Black frame; single designed sound.	—
32.15 END TITLE CARD (white on black): "Most women trafficked into sex work are not taken by strangers. They are invited in by someone they trust." A helpline number appears beneath it. Use a current, verified national helpline at the time of release. ROLL CREDITS over the sound of Hyderabad waking up. CAMERA Title card graphics; credits over city ambience.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot at true sunrise; wet down the terrace for the post-storm glitter. The final push-in on Rani is one continuous dolly move, about 60 seconds; the cut to black lands on her opening her mouth. The final sound (trunk set down or lifted) is designed ambiguously in post. End title card text and helpline must be verified before release. Sravya's employer stays generic ("a big audit firm") — no real company names.